

A WHY CHOOSE HOCKEY ROMANCE

Wonder



Girl



CHARM HARLOW

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Tropes and Content Warnings

Hockey romance

Why choose/reverse harem

Spice

Standalone

Revenge

Golden retriever men

Insta-love

They fall first and hard

Fast burn

Palate cleanser novella (short, sweet and spicy)

Boy obsessed

No third act break up

This romance contains double penetration, anal, impact play, anilingus, breeding, voyeurism, exhibitionism, and very light reverse college professor-student kink play. Enjoy!

Chapter 1

Ava

Our Field Geology trip getting canceled because the bus “broke down” isn’t so bad. Instead of wasting away a perfectly good weekend in the middle of summer trying to learn about rocks (which I adore by the way because geology is my passion, but I don’t love it more than a cloud-free weekend), I get to spend it with my boyfriend, Will. Excitement courses through me as I pull up to his apartment building in my Beetle, the setting sun casting an orange glow on the pale jade walls. I pick up the bag with the champagne and blueberry muffins I baked for him, and, as the elevator ascends, my heart flutters as it always does whenever I’m about to see him. When I knock on his apartment door, I fix my middle part for the millionth time, knowing how picky he is about hair. His own is never messy, each strand always perfect and flattened.

The door opens and a tanned blonde girl my age pokes her head through.

My best friend, Angie Walters.

With messy hair.

Her tan is deep but I still see her turn as red as ketchup.

For a moment, we stare at each other. It’s not unlike the times we’ve looked at each other in horror, such as when our other best friend, Kelly Kinger, cut off all her luscious hair in sixth grade because her mom wouldn’t let her come to the Austin Mahone-themed sleepover we were having at my house.

“Who is it?” I hear Will call behind her in his usual bored voice.

My mouth moves but nothing comes out of it.

“Babe, who is it?” Will repeats.

Babe? I realize by how Angie flinches I've spat the word out.

Her blue eyes are wide as dinner plates. A sound comes out of her throat, hoarse and panicky.

"Oh, I forgot," I hear Will chuckle as he thumps towards the door. "You just lost your voice because I made you scream so much like a ___"

When he appears, I'm still so surprised at how big he is, and seeing him next to my tiny bestie only emphasizes this feeling. His own blue eyes widen, his mouth falling open slightly.

"Babe?" he asks, surprised.

My voice comes out in a vicious growl. "Me or her?"

"Shit —" He looks out of place. He usually sports this nonchalant, hockey-bro persona but right now, I've never seen him look so... chalang? He splutters, looking between me and Angie like he can't figure out which one is his girlfriend and which one is the bestie.

Look. If it had been anyone else, I'd be gone already. In my car, bawling my eyes out. I'd be fine in like six weeks (maybe).

But I've known Angie since fourth grade. She was going to be my maid of honor, the godmother of my kids.

I look at her. "Why?" My voice shakes and angry tears threaten to fill my eyes.

She opens her mouth but she sounds like a crow choking on a rock and just gives up, placing her face in her hands.

"This... isn't what it looks like," Will breathes out the cliché line.

"It isn't?" I laugh. I take a step back. "I just heard you confessing to fucking my best friend to the point she can't speak!"

Will gives an exasperated sigh like I'm making way too much of a big deal of this.

College hockey players. This is who they are. The signs were there, of course, but ignoring them was easier than letting them

fester poisonously in my mind.

Firstly, Will is the embodiment of Chad. From his voice to his mannerisms and the hair of course (which by the way, is currently all over the place like little Ms Traitor's).

Secondly, he once told me, drunk on the eve of his twentieth birthday, that he slept with half the girls at U of T during his freshman year. Then he said I love you to me for the first time and passed out on the couch.

Enough said.

Frustrated, he runs a hand down his face. "I thought you were going for that trip to... where was it?" He says it more to himself. I never expected him to remember where the geology trip was since he never remembers things concerning me or our relationship, from our dates to when we have to visit each other's families. Last year, he completely forgot my birthday. Which was okay because he was going through a really rough patch. He hadn't been drafted by his dream team, the Toronto Icy.

To say Will used to be obsessed with the Icy is an understatement. Ever since he was a kid he had dreamed of skating in the Wesley Arena and lifting the Stanley Cup for them. He had memorabilia, he had autographs from players that retired in the early 2000s.

He was so sure they were going to pick him and had already started calling himself an Icy forward, how he would soon replace one of the players in the famous HCH forward line that consists of center Brady Hayes, left winger and captain Sean Campbell and right winger Noah Hughes. He'd even made a joke about if he was going to be an Icy player, then he'd have to get an "Icy-worthy girlfriend and upgrade" from me, a joke I hadn't found funny at all but you'd think the opposite from how I reacted.

Still, I felt really bad for him when they — or any other team — didn't select him during the draft. His mood became terrible. He didn't want to be around anyone and I kept my distance for two

weeks, two weeks where I anguished over him and felt useless because there was nothing I could do for him that would make him feel better.

What *did* make him feel better was hating on the Icy. He got rid of most of his merch – but kept the ones with too much sentimental value. He began supporting the Chicago Otters and bad-mouthing the HCH line. I was kinda all for it, so long as it brought him back to me, though I knew this wasn't healthy, and there had to be better ways to vent his frustrations.

It's his final year to get drafted by a team, any team. The Draft occurs a couple of days after the Stanley Cup finals, which are ongoing: the Icy themselves vs the Otters. I'm not big on hockey myself but it becomes a part of your life when your boyfriend is a player.

Your boyfriend who's just cheated on you with your best friend.

"Yeah, the bus broke down," I say, answering his question about how I'm not supposed to be here, "which I'm pretty sure was just Caden Jones' sneaking out at night and smashing out some part. I should thank him with my life because now I know *everything*."

I feel tired, hopeless. Ms. Traitor still has her face buried in her hands and hasn't moved for a good minute. I'm not even angry at her, strangely, not really. Just... tired and hopeless.

"And as for you, Angie... I hope ruining a long-time close friendship was worth it for a man. But then I should have figured it out when you only wanted to hang out with me when he was around during the past few months." I look Will in the eye, who at this point is looking bored by the whole situation like he wants to go back to highlights about the Icy and Otters. "Fuck both of you."

I turn away, walking slowly back to my car, willing myself not to cry because I will not shed a tear over a cheater and a backstabbing best friend. The bag of champagne and muffins I baked feels heavy and I want to drop it and get out of there and run somewhere, anywhere that'll make this pain go away.

In my car I sit there for a whole minute, contemplating my entire life, how it's been a lie, before I drive off, barely aware of where I'm going.

Dating a hockey player . I snort as I turn into the road where my parents' house is and it comes out as half a sob. Who the fuck dates a hockey player and expects them to be faithful? This bitch driving a 2005 VW Beetle into her childhood home driveway.

Mom, brunette and heart-shaped like me, pokes her head out of the door, sporting a half frown because I'm supposed to be out of town, and a half delighted smile because I haven't seen her and Dad in forever. I instantly feel better and the tears stop, though my reddened eyes will give me away and make them worry. I decide not to say anything about Will and Angie. I'm just going to let this issue... fade away.

No more hockey players. Scratch that: no more dating. No more relationships. Just me and a glass of wine, forever.

Chapter 2

Sean

Two years ago, there wasn't even a shred of hope in us making the playoffs. And right now, if we don't shoot the puck right between the Otters' goalie's legs, then we would've let the Stanley Cup slip right through our fingers.

I let the world fade away into nothing. The only people that exist are my teammates Brady and Noah, myself, and the goalie.

I glide on the ice, the puck in my possession before passing it to Brady a little too erratically, who snatches it before it could fly out of his reach. Shit, that was a horrible pass.

The three of us make toward the goalie relentlessly, and when Brady passes the puck to Noah, I hold my breath.

Noah makes the shot and the puck zooms right into the net.

The roar that fills the arena is deafening. My team crowds around Noah, who's now made us lead the Otters 4-3. With only a few seconds remaining, the chances of taking this to a seventh and final game are all but assured.

When the third period comes to an end, I breathe a huge sigh of relief.

"Fuck yeah!" I roar as I enter the changing room after doing my post-game interview. I'm greeted with a faceful of champagne and when I duck, the stream follows me.

Fucking Brady. I tackle him and he cackles like he's already won the Cup.

“Save that for when we actually win,” I say, grinning, snatching the bottle from him.

Brady ignores me and picks up another unopened one. Sighing and shaking my head, I turn to Noah.

“I know, I know,” I say, holding up a hand when he draws breath to speak. “That was the worst pass all season.”

Noah closes his mouth and scowls before laughing and pulling me in for a rib-cracking hug.

Though our journey to the finals was fairly easy, the Otters have given us hell. We won Game 1 but then lost Games 2, 3 and 4. We then woke from our stupor and won the next two and have now taken it to a decider. We’ll be flying to Chicago in two days and hopefully, we’ll come back with the Cup.

Looking at the changing room, that’s a big if. A celebratory brawl has started that has two of the best defensemen in the world on the floor, clutching their stomachs and faces, and I have to yell to get it to stop. Being the captain, yelling and snatching champagne make up ninety-nine percent of my duties.

“Alright, that’s enough!” I manage to get their attention and I can’t help but grin at them all, these loveable, hardworking fucks. “Good game, y’all, keep it up. The Cup is ours if we don’t lose our focus. It’s fucking ours! ICY FOR THE WIN!”

After they bellow the mantra back, family and friends are allowed in. Kids run into their dads’ open arms and spouses and girlfriends hug and kiss their men.

I’m not gonna lie, standing there, Noah, Brady, and I feel out of place. It feels a little better when some of the girlfriends and spouses come to hug us too. When I hug Cameron, McDonald’s boyfriend, for a moment too long, fucking with our surly goalie, he gives me the stink eye and I have to let go before he throws his helmet at me.

“How are you so starved of affection when you’re always with these two?” he says to me, jabbing a finger in Noah and Brady’s

direction while holding Cameron close to him possessively.

"It's not like that," Noah mutters, exasperated, changing out of his equipment. "And don't be so loud, dammit, there are nosy journalists everywhere." He eyes the lockers suspiciously. "Probably hiding in the walls."

"Getting bored of the bunnies?" McDonald teases.

"Babe, don't call them that," Cameron says, lacing an arm over McDonald's shoulders. "It's not nice."

"Whatever you want," McDonald says with devoted eyes on his partner. It's been two years since he came out and despite receiving some shit in the first couple of months he's been happily dating Cameron for the past year and I've never seen a love so pure and strong. Right now they look like they're about to bite each other's faces off as they stare deep into each other's eyes.

I want that.

When we're done changing into casualwear, Noah, Brady, and I leave the arena, signing autographs from excited fans on our way out. This is the best part, interacting with our admirers and supporters, and seeing how much we mean to them. The fans are our extended family, especially for us three who don't have anyone to go home to.

Our parents are in the driveway and after congratulating us, we get into our Maserati and I drive us to our condo in the west of Toronto.

From the passenger seat, Noah bumps shoulders with me. "What's up with you?"

"Nothing," I say. I mean, I should be excited we just won Game 6, but there's a certain... emptiness to it all.

Brady brings out his phone. "Do you want us to call Maggie? She'll be at the condo in like five minutes, even though she lives on the other side of town, that's how thirsty she gets."

Maggie's the girl we've been fucking for the past week, but I'm already bored of her. She's great, but there's absolutely no connection there. Just sex. A nice pair of tits in my face would feel amazing right now, but... I think I'd rather go to the club and celebrate with the rest of the team. Family just feels so much more important right now.

"I think we'll just go to the condo to freshen up and we'll meet the other guys at Benjamin's," I say. "Could go for a big celebration right now."

The sleek building, where our condo is one of twenty units, appears out of the darkness, lights from vast windows glowing. I ease into the parking and reverse into our spot. I don't know if I'm imagining it, but in the distance, I hear people chanting, *Icy! Icy!* Fuck, I love this city.

"Hear that?" Brady says. "We did that. After years and years, we gave our fans hope."

In our condo, decorated with cold masculine colors and styles, we change in our separate bedrooms. We bought the property together about two years ago when the three of us landed a huge sponsorship. By the end of the season, we'll be able to afford a nice homely place, preferably a mansion on the outskirts of the city. We don't even need to win the title; our story of our fight and perseverance will make many brands want to associate with us.

But a big sponsorship deal isn't what I'm interested in mainly.

What I want is someone who I'll come back home to, in addition to these two. Someone we can share, but on a more meaningful level than sex. Someone like —

"A wife?" Noah says. I turn around in my massive bathroom with dark tiles to see one of my best friends dressed in jeans and a T-shirt.

"What?"

“That's what you want, isn't it?” he says, coming in and stealing some of my lotion, rubbing it into his calloused palms. “That's what you've been thinking of.”

I don't answer him, looking at the two of us in my mirror. We're both huge and broad-shouldered and dark-haired but Noah's slightly taller than me. My eyes are dark and impenetrable, and his are a light green.

“Did I hear the word ‘wife’?” Brady says, coming in and running a hand through his wet blond hair, just as broad as we are, but the shortest of us at six-two. “Are we finally having this conversation?”

“Not a wife per se, but you know, someone... someone special,” I say. “I don't think we should be jumping to marriage that quick but these things, these victories, they just hit differently when you know you're doing it for someone and celebrating with someone.” I look at them both. “Just imagine if we had someone else here with us to celebrate winning the Stanley Cup.”

All three of us contemplate in silence.

We walk out of the bathroom. Brady gestures at the large open lounge. “I mean, this place *could* use a feminine touch. It's a little dark and boring. I didn't think we'd have these conversations so soon.” He sighs. “I mean, we're only in our mid-twenties.”

Noah and I follow him to the door. “I don't know if that perfect girl exists, though,” he says.

A lot of the girls we meet aren't genuine. They like us... too much. There's no flavor. It's just them tripping over themselves to impress us and doing whatever we like. Shit gets boring after a while.

Down in the car basement, we get into the Ferrari, this time Brady driving.

“Shit, how fucking insane would it be if we met someone tonight now that we've put this out into the universe and everything,” Noah says in the passenger seat, absently scrolling on his phone.

The three of us, along with most of our hockey team, are superstitious as fuck. We believe in signs, in good luck charms, and willing things to happen.

“I don't know,” Brady says. “It seems a little late for that, don't you think? Finding a perfect girl to call our own and celebrate tonight's win, and maybe the Stanley Cup, with.” He chuckles. “If that happens, I'll lose my shit.”

Chapter 3

Ava

It's around nine in the evening and I'm sitting alone at a table in Benjamin's bar, the saddest girl in the world.

Jazz music plays and it's like I'm in a movie, sentimentally stirring my virgin mojito. The world looks so grey, even though there are celebrations around me, people relishing the recent Toronto Icy win.

I just can't bring myself to celebrate. I know Will hates the Icy now, and he must be furious the Otters couldn't come out on top, which should lift my mood. But I just can't find any joy or satisfaction from that.

Every bar I've tried has a small party going on celebrating the win, so it's not like I can go anywhere else. I settled for this one because it's the one closest to my apartment. And the bartender is really nice. She's been keeping an eye on me all the time after immediately noticing I'm not my usual self.

I take a sip of my drink, checking my phone for new texts from Kelly, my only remaining best friend.

I would have just stayed at my parents' home, curled under my old blankets in my old bedroom. But that was a horrible idea because I started to get memories of the sleepovers and the times Angie, Kelly, and I used to gossip about boys and school drama. Fuck. I still don't understand why anyone would ruin a friendship for a man.

Mom and Dad noticed I was sad, and they tried their best to cheer me up. Mom baked me some cookies, but I couldn't taste their strawberry goodness. Dad tried with his dad jokes, but all they got was half a giggle from me before I fell back into despair.

Before I left, I lied and told them I was feeling much better, trying to muster a smile, though I knew they didn't really believe it.

Kelly has been an incredible comfort. I told her everything and she flew into a rage on my behalf. I'm pretty sure she sent Angie a couple of nasty texts, too. She's doing her psychology degree at TMU. We had a friend group that consisted of the three of us but Kelly immediately kicked Angie out of it and she's blocked her on all social media just like I have.

I look at the last text Kelly sent me and it's just filled with expletives against Angie and some of them are so funny I find myself giggling.

Apparently, if a girl giggles, it signifies to guys they can approach her.

I've been turning away a lot of them ever since I got here. But since I have such a high-pitched voice that can be heard over yells and shouting and music, and therefore a high-pitched giggle, the Chads on the other table who've been watching me like lions watching a zebra think that makes me approachable.

I said I was done with men, so I look up from my phone, smile, because if I get too nasty, who knows what these men will do, and say, "Sorry, not interested."

The other guys behind him make a series of whooping sounds, and the Chad in front of me turns red in the face. He's a good sport about it, though, because he just turns around and goes back to his seat. I breathe out a sigh of relief.

I take another sip of my drink.

"You got a boyfriend or something?!" one of the guys who made whooping sounds yells over the noise.

I take another sip and nod. "Yeah, he's about to join me." I know some men aren't intimidated by a woman having a boyfriend. In fact, that makes the woman even more alluring to them. I guess it's the

same with girls. A taken man to some girls is more attractive than a single man.

Will and Angie walk into the bar, holding hands.

If my stomach wasn't rolling in horror, I would have thought they were a cute couple. Angie's dressed in tight jeans and a black tank top that shows off boobs I've always been envious of, her blonde hair in a messy bun. Next to her, Will looks huge and muscular. They look like the typical hockey couple.

Anger rises in me. I want to throw my phone at them, but I don't want to crack the screen that costs as much as the phone itself. Maybe I should throw the glass, but I don't want to risk the friendship I have with the bartender, so I stay put, seething.

I scooch deeper into the corner I'm sitting in, hoping they don't notice me. The bar is semi-dark, so I have an advantage. I shouldn't look at my phone so much, or at least I should lower the brightness so my face isn't lit up. The new couple is still at the bar ordering their drinks, and then they move to a table right next to it.

Just then, the music changes to something more upbeat, with a thumping bass, and Angie sways her shoulders.

Traitorous bitch.

After that, there comes soft, seductive music. A man enters the room, and I immediately recognize him as one of Will's dudebro friends, Jase. He spots the cozy pair, and I see his eyebrows rise.

"So, when's Ava coming back from her trip?" he says.

My heart sinks. I don't particularly like Jase. I don't know why I expected him to be on my side, or to tell me his best friend was cheating on me.

"Keep up with the times, brother," I hear Will say. "We broke up. She was nothing but a glorified puck slut, anyway. A long-term one."

Jase's eyebrows rise higher as he grabs a chair from another table and joins them on theirs. "Wait, but I thought she was your girl?"

“Nah,” Will says, and Angie gives a nervous laugh. I can't tell if she looks uncomfortable or not. Glorified puck slut, huh? I wanna laugh, but I have to keep it in if I don't want to get noticed.

I glance at the Chads next to me. They're still watching me, eyes rolling over my body. If they were a different type of group, perhaps a nerdy type, I might have engaged with them, to make Will jealous and show him *he* was nothing but a glorified dildo. But that won't work, because it seems like I'm still thinking about him and being petty. And Angie laughed? Oh, it's taking everything in me to keep my ass on this seat.

The best thing to do would be to leave, drive to my apartment, put on some Netflix, eat some of the leftover gin and tonic cake I made, and sleep.

Yeah, that sounds like a great time. However...

I need to make sure I don't get spotted when I leave because it's almost impossible for me or any girl to walk across the club without a couple of guys glancing over. Shit, I can't make them see me. The awkwardness would be too much and I might just get angry and cause a scene.

I could cover my face but Will is probably very familiar with the way I walk, Angie too, and my perfume is so strong and distinctive despite the bar being filled with different kinds. And they know what I was wearing from earlier. And if I cover my face entirely, I could fall and draw even more attention to myself.

How do I get out of this one?

I could turn off the lights, bolt to the door and to freedom. But I'm pretty sure that'll get me banned from Benjamin's.

Why did I even come here? I have lime juice and soda water at my house.

I see Will stretch leisurely and cast a look around the bar. When his eyes scan in my direction, my heart stops. Shit. But he doesn't really notice me, his attention going back to Angie's chest.

Okay, I need to get out of here. I stand and try to walk differently and change my posture, my face in my hands. I'm in heels, which I couldn't change out of since there aren't any of my clothes at my parents' house. If I fall, then it is what it is. But I just have to try.

I stand, feeling the entire club's eyes on me. My face is covered with my hands and I'm only able to see through the gaps in my fingers. I push my shoulders back, push my tits out, and try to swing my hips a lot as I do a little jog toward the entrance. I can feel Will, Angie, and Jase's eyes on me, but I'm almost there. I increase my pace and I'm almost to the threshold when I bang into something hard.

Fuck, the door is closed, partially because I can feel the wind on me. I increase the space between my fingers and yeah, the door is definitely not open all the way. It's just mostly a wall of darkness. Covering my face with one hand, I push the door with my other, but my hand lands on something soft and hard at the same time. Stepping back, I see who I've touched, whose abs my fingers caressed.

A large man. A very large man. A very large and familiar man.

That wasn't the door I ran into, it was his chest.

"Oh, fuck, I am so sorry," I squeak. "I didn't mean to, I thought it was the door. It's because I couldn't see where I was going and —"

"It's okay," he says in an impossibly deep voice.

He's smirking.

I... Oh. My. Fuck.

"That was not cool," I continue, my voice shaky now. "It was a mistake, it was an accident."

"He said it's alright," the other, more than familiar man next to him says. He too is smirking, one of two sexy-as-shit smirks being angled down at me. The third man is not smirking. He's looking at me like he can't believe his eyes. I guess he's the only one who realizes it is *not* cool to go around groping other people's hard as fucking fuck abs.

"I'm so sorry," I say to him. He shakes his head like he's coming out of a stupor.

It's them. Them! The HCH line. The men I was forced to be familiar with by Will because he was such a fanboy of them.

In real life, they are just impossible. Impossible is the right word. I have never seen such good-looking men in my life. The one I ran into, Brady, has this boyish charm to his long, strong and beautiful face. Noah, the one who told me not to worry so much, has a slightly brutal look about him, like he looks like he's mean and he hates people but in, like, an *extremely* hot way.

And then there's the captain of the Icy, Sean. He's the one who's just staring at me like I'm an alien, his sensuous full lips parted, his thickly lashed, dark eyes wide.

How is it possible for people to look this good? And to *smell* so good, too. My eyes land on their bulging arms while they eye me up and down. All this takes about six seconds, but it feels like an eternity. Time slows down and the world around us shrinks away.

It doesn't take time for the rest of the bar to notice who's just walked in and it's like an explosion has just happened. The screams are crazy! I step sideways into the bar, my hands over my ears. I can even feel the walls shaking, and the glasses on the bar shelf are definitely going to shatter.

People crowd around them, and the number one person in front is Will, who probably spotted me, but next to these guys, I'm nothing more than a shadow.

The guys smile and cheer with everyone, and I see pens and merch whipping out of handbags and pockets as the bar suddenly feels too small now that three giants have walked in.

The hand I touched *the* Brady Hayes with is still warm, and if I was a wiser girl, I wouldn't wash it for the rest of my life.

But I shake my head. Why am I fawning over hockey players? Get your shit together, Ava.

I try to head for the door, but a couple of fans have come up from behind the HCH line to attempt to touch their backs corded with muscle, so the door is barricaded. Great. As I'm getting shoved this way and that, one amusing thought sticks with me. I thought Will hated the Icy forwards. But then again, I guess it's a weird kind of hate-love. Your biggest haters are usually your biggest fans.

I look behind me at him, and he looks like he's going to explode if he doesn't get a fistful of Noah Hughes's shoulder. The thought of him being desperate and pathetic brings comfort to me.

I look away from Will to Brady Hayes himself, and my heart skips to see him staring at me. In fact, all three NHL players are staring at me. There are dozens of people trying to get to them, and the only person they are focused on is Ava Anderson.

My heart skips in my chest, and I look away. There's now a tiny space in the door, and I take the chance. I squeeze myself through it, and I'm thrust outside into the fresh, summer air.

I take in a deep breath, trying to recover from both the press of bodies and the sight of three monstrous-looking men looking at me like I'm dinner. I apologized for accidentally touching Hayes's abs, didn't I?

I'm wondering why the three of them don't have bodyguards to avoid such fan-crazed scenes, but then again, they don't really need security. No one in their right mind would think to attack them and they look like they were handling the situation pretty well.

I walk quickly to my car, scared the three bears might come out and give me shit about inappropriately touching one of the NHL's best forwards. The sight of my jade Beetle is comforting and just as I'm about six feet away from it, I hear a voice behind me.

"Hey." The voice is deep and commanding. It's a voice I've heard on TV a lot, bossing around his teammates.

When I turn around, Sean Campbell is walking towards me.

I go still. “Look, I’m really sorry about what happened,” I say quickly, defensively. “I didn’t mean to, I was trying to avoid someone, so I was covering my face.”

Sean stands before me, and I have to bend my neck a full ninety degrees to look up at him. “I really didn’t mean to.”

Sean stoops slightly, placing both his massive hands on my shoulders. “Relax, OK?” he says. His face is up close to mine. “We get it. It was an accident. We just... I mean...” His words falter, and all he does is just stare at me. We just stand there in silence as I also just stare.

He’s *gorgeous* .

“What’s your name?” he says.

“I— ” I’ve forgotten my name. Then it comes back to me. ‘Ava.’

“Ava.” He tastes my name, making me shiver a little. “Where are you going?”

“Well, I was gonna go home, but I don’t really feel like it because it’s kinda depressing there. So maybe... to the amusement park, I guess?”

I hear footsteps behind Sean. It’s the other two and right behind them is a small crowd of people, their phones out. Tallest among them is Will, leading them and looking the most eager.

“Sounds like a good time,” Sean says. “We don’t really feel like partying ourselves.”

Over Sean’s shoulder, I see Brady politely brush aside two girls who have their hands on his arms.

“Wait, you wanna come to the amusement park?” I say in disbelief. “With *me* ?”

“Yeah, why not?” Noah says in his deep, growly voice.

My mouth has gone dry. Again, I look past Sean, and my eyes lock with Will’s. He’s looking shocked and furious, his phone out and recording us as others chatter excitedly amongst themselves.

“Ava?” Will says. He genuinely sounds surprised, so that means he didn't notice me inside the bar. Next to him is Jase and Angie, her mouth slightly open.

I look back into Sean's face with a wide smile on my face.

“Sure thing,” I say.

Chapter 4

Noah

She's driving a 2005 Beetle, or maybe a 2006. We crowd into it and the interior smells of lavender. She's in the driver's seat with Sean in the passenger, and Brady and I are squeezed in the back.

For a moment, she just sits there like she's forgotten what to do next and it's cute as fuck. Then she shakes her head and places the key in the ignition.

Outside, the fans have come close to the car, pressing their phones to the windows. Security is pointless to us, but a couple of moments ago, it seemed necessary. When fans see bodyguards, they keep their distance, but when it's just the three of us, they swarm us, and we can't exactly use our manpower against them or turn them away.

Usually, it's fine, we love our fans, but this time, there was a girl, a girl we almost lost.

I'm not gonna lie, I panicked when I saw she'd left the bar. She could've hailed an Uber, and we would've never seen her again — it's lucky she has a car, and we found her in the parking lot.

It takes a while to get out of the parking lot, seeing as there's a crowd around us, and when we break free, she drives into the freeway that'll take us to Wonderland. We move in silence, the only sound is the whoosh of passing cars. The smell of lavender is intoxicating, it's strongest on her and I have to fight the urge to lean in closer to the driver's seat.

"Um, so do you guys want some music?" she says after clearing her throat.

“Sure,” Sean says and she plays some low pop music. From the front seat, I can tell he's wonderstruck like I am and trying hard not to stare sideways at her.

I'm not exaggerating when I say this is the most fucking beautiful girl I've ever seen in twenty-five years of life.

Fuck.

She has long brown hair that's tucked behind both her ears and I can't exactly tell what color her eyes are from this angle but they're dark and big. She has full lips and a slightly upturned nose and her chin is pointed. The elegant curve of her neck is driving me crazy, man.

Who exactly is this girl?

I groan a little, placing my head on the headrest. I could just stay in this car with its lavender smell and stare at her side profile for the rest of my life.

One thing I noticed, though, is that her face is puffy. I'm not sure what her regular face looks like, but I can tell when somebody's been crying or just generally looks stressed out. Is that why she was at the bar, trying to drown out her sorrows with alcohol or in somebody's arms? She'd covered her face like she had been crying when she ran into Brady. Maybe she'd been trying to avoid someone. I want to ask her, suddenly feeling protective of her, but maybe that's not a good idea as she could be going through some real rough shit. If that's the case, what she needs is an escape.

“So, um, congratulations on your win tonight,” she says, her voice shaking a little.

Fuck, that breaks my heart. She's already going through something and we're making her nervous. It's our job to make her feel comfortable.

I know the other two have noticed too because the three of us are always in tune with each other. That's just how we work. We like the same things. We mostly think the same. It's like we have one body

and one brain and sometimes I'm not sure if that's a good thing or not.

"Thanks," Brady drawls. "We wouldn't be here if it wasn't for my assist, of course."

Trust Brady to lighten the situation.

"And it's lucky Brady has the skill to control crazy passes," I put in.

"You're not ever letting that go, are you?" Sean says to me.

"Nah," I say.

Sean chuckles, shaking his head, then turns to gaze at her. "Who are you, Ava?" he asks softly.

She laughs nervously. "There's nothing really interesting about me. You guys should do all the talking, you're *much* more interesting."

"Yeah, but it gets boring always being the center of attention," Sean replies. "Please, Ava, tell us about you."

"Okay, well, my name is Ava. Oh wait, you already know that. Um, so—"

"What do you do?" I help.

"Well," she says. "I'm a geology student at U of T. That's pretty boring compared to hockey, I guess."

"Really? Geology? Like, rocks and shit?" Brady says.

"Like rocks and shit," she says, grinning. Fuck. Her sideways profile looks amazing with that smile on and her teeth are straight and so white.

"I'm sure it's more than that though, right?" Sean says. "Ava, you think you could give us a comprehensive idea of what geology is all about?"

Her smile goes wider.

"Geology." She sighs. "Oh, it's amazing. It's like the study of how our planet was shaped, you know. It's how mountains are formed,

canyons, gorges, all that stuff. There's just something so fascinating about rocks and their layers and what they tell us about previous life on Earth. It's like unfolding a mystery, you know.”

She goes on and there's this look on her face that's inspiring. It's the same look I get when I'm talking about hockey on TV, a look I've seen on Sean and Brady's faces too.

She goes into more detail about tectonic plates and how important geologists are, though people don't really think they are.

“Geology is definitely more important for the planet and its survival than hockey players, I know that much,” Brady says.

She shakes her head. “Entertainment’s just as important,” she says. “What's life if it's all about studying? I mean, earlier today a school trip was canceled and I was glad because I didn't want to waste a summer weekend —”

She stops talking abruptly. Something's wrong. There's a frown on her face and she shakes her head.

“Anyway, that's geology and that's why I'm studying it,” she adds in a weary voice.

If I had to guess, what just made her stop talking is the reason her face is swollen. I want to know what's bothering her but maybe she's not comfortable sharing that with three guys she just met who're already obsessed with her. And besides, we're going to an amusement park. We're gonna have fun, good vibes allowed only.

We arrive at Wonderland and in the parking lot, we realize paparazzi were following us as little scooters park all around us. One of them even takes a picture while the damn vehicle's still moving.

They swarm us and automatically my feet take me around the car to the driver's door where Ava stands, looking confused by all the flashing and yells.

“Hey, come with me, Ava,” I say to her.

“Is this what your life is like every day?” she says, as she lets me wrap an arm around her, her body so soft and warm. I know she's

not in any real danger, but I'm just feeling super protective. She seems grateful for it because she presses her body into mine.

Fuck. There's just something about a woman relying on you for protection that makes you want to fight every man on Earth. Or maybe it's just her, an effect only she has on me.

"No, not every day," I say reassuringly. I'm not lying, we don't really get followed by paparazzi, only when there's a media frenzy about us like now, since we just won Game 6. I don't want her to think, she has to deal with this shit every day if she ever gets with us.

Fuck, I'm already thinking of the future with this girl. I don't think I've ever done that so quickly after meeting someone.

I do everything in my power not to growl like a maniac at the paparazzi. Sean and Brady give them looks that are enough to make them keep their distance before Sean turns to Ava. "Lead the way, Ava. It's all you."

She nods, and I gently free her from my embrace. "Um, so we can try the merry-go-round first? It's the closest one." She points at it.

"I don't know," Brady says, "those horses look a little too small for us."

"If he can do it, so can you," Ava says, pointing at a man who has to be at least 6'10" and a lot more muscular than any of us, riding that thing like an expert.

"Damn, there goes my excuse," Brady says with a defeated grin.

Ava giggles, and the sound is like music. "Let's go then before it fills up."

A year ago, no one really knew the Icy because we're a relatively new team, and they certainly weren't aware of Sean, Brady, and me. Back then, we could go out without being stared and pointed at, but because now we're in the finals —

"OMG, it's them!" says a guy and everyone near him turns to look. "The HCH line!"

It's still surreal to me how an everyday person knows what "HCH line" means.

Some of the parkgoers notice Ava with us and begin whispering and pointing at her. I can already smell the tabloid headlines.

Phones are brought out and the gathering crowd and paparazzi start to get a little invasive. I mean, I just want to go on a date with my bros and a cute girl.

There's a high level of skill required to mount one of these merry-go-round horses. They are tiny as fuck and I eye the 6'10" dude, who's just finished his own ride, with amazement.

"How did he do that?" I mutter, fidgeting in my own saddle. It's not comfortable, it's like sitting my ass on concrete.

Ava laughs, throwing her head back.

"It's easy for you," I say. I mean, her hips are wide and her ass is full, but she's still small and she doesn't have these long-ass hockey legs.

When the ride starts going, the comedy just intensifies. My bros and I look ridiculous. Sean is clutching the pole like his life depends on it because if he doesn't, he'll go tumbling sideways and Brady has his legs wrapped around the horse's middle so tightly, he's gonna burst a vein.

Ava, on the other hand, is queen of the merry-go-round. Her hair floats up and down with the movements of the ride and she's laughing, one hand on the pole, and the other thrown to the side. It's a sight I know I'll always remember down to the tiniest of details.

"This your favorite ride?" Sean says as he slips slowly to the left.

"They're all my favorite rides," she says.

"The last time I was on one of these I was a reasonable size," I say. I'm not enjoying this at all, so I focus on the one thing I *am* enjoying, which is Ava. All three of us guys are doing the same thing. We're enchanted by this girl who came out of nowhere, this wonder girl the universe sent to us.

“Next ride,” she says when we’re on solid ground again. It’s fascinating how this girl is more interested in the rides than fawning over us. She hasn’t asked us for an autograph. She hasn’t even really asked about hockey or anything. She just wants to have fun, and she wants us to come along with her and I’m so deep in a trance I realize what we’re doing next — rollercoaster — when it’s too late.

I don’t do rollercoasters. See, I’m actually kind of terrified of them and that’s the reason I haven’t gone to any amusement park in a while. Last time I was on one of these I passed out and my friends back in my home city, Boston, laughed at me for hours. I didn’t like being made fun of, so I just generally stayed away from rollercoasters.

“Bro, Noah,” Sean says. I’ve been left behind and they’re standing a few feet away in the line.

“I’m not really big on rollercoasters, man,” I say.

“What?” Brady says, and a huge, opportunistic grin comes on his face. He means well, but he doesn’t know how much this shit traumatized me as a kid.

“I don’t like rollercoasters.” I look at Ava. She’s looking at me, concerned.

“You don’t have to come on one if you don’t want to,” she says, which just makes me seem like a little bitch, which I’m not.

“No, no, I’ll come. I just need a minute.”

“Hey,” she says, coming close to me, “you don’t have to do anything you don’t want to. Fuck what anyone else thinks.”

I take in a breath, a little surprised by how forward her words are.

“Nah, I’ll do it because at least *you’ve* been understanding about it.” I shoot a jokingly accusatory glance at Brady, who grins even wider, the asshole. She gives her hand to me and it’s so small with its white nails and several rings. I take it in mine and she goes red a little. Her skin is cold and I squeeze her fingers a little to warm her up and she squeezes my own back reassuringly and suddenly I’m not

that scared of going on this shit anymore. I don't know how to explain it but... she's wiped away any hesitation I was feeling.

Sean and Brady are side by side on the rollercoaster while Ava and I sit next to each other, still holding hands.

When we're off, she screams. All I'm doing is focusing on her as she's laughing, her hair all over her face, her hand tightly gripping mine. There's a little apprehension at the pit of my stomach, but the sight of Ava having the time of her life keeps it down and I don't pass out.

When we come down from it, she's giggling. "You did it!" she says.

"I did," I say, feeling a little dizzy but mostly fine. "Thanks for that."

We stare at each other for a long beat. I want to close the space between us and kiss those full lips and breathe her air and she probably feels the electricity humming between us too because she turns red.

"So, um, yeah," she says shyly. "Booths next."

I nod as she walks away to them. When I look sideways, I see Brady and Sean smirking and wiggling their eyebrows at me and I roll my eyes at them. "She said booths next, fuckers," I say, shoving them to follow Ava.

At this point, it's pretty easy to ignore the sneaking paparazzi and following crowds. I'm too distracted by Ava, her face, her laugh, that body. At the shooting booth, Sean, Brady and I are able to shoot our targets and win a ginormous teddy bear each. Ava is a sure shot, too, and she gives us her own furry prize.

"For us?" Sean says.

She nods. "My gift to you," she says. "I haven't had fun like this in a while, so... thank you."

"Dang," Brady says, who looks touched as he takes the bear from her. "I'll give mine to you at the end of the night but I'll carry it for you because, well, it's half your size."

“Mine too,” Sean and I say.

Before shit gets nice and sentimental right now, there's a loud gasp to our left. An acrobatic show has just started right there in the street, and we watch in awe as they flip in the air, spinning and throwing each other, catching each other at the last moment. We're in the way, so we move closer to a hot dog stand, where I buy us each one. Ava looks famished and devours hers like I do mine because I haven't eaten since before Game 6, which feels like an eternity ago. This night feels like years have passed and we've known Ava in all that time.

“So where next?” I say, not wanting this night to end.

Ava doesn't even look tired as she looks around. “We haven't gone on the *wheel* yet,” she says.

“Great,” I say. “Wheel it is.”

We're headed there, all of us singing along to someone performing *Take Me Out to the Ball Game*, when suddenly there's a screech, and hair and tank tops everywhere.

“No fucking way, it's *Hughes* !”

“Captain Sean, please sign my shirt, please, PLEASE!”

“Haaaayes! *Haaayes* !”

Fuck's sake, man. Honestly, I'm surprised this didn't happen earlier. There have to be at least two dozen girls on us and they all want a piece. I want to run, but we can't be jerks to our fans and I see a similar sentiment cross my teammates' faces, so I grab the nearest pen that's being shoved in my face and begin signing things with a mild smile. Shirts, jerseys, hockey romance novels, pucks. I see Ava standing a little away from the press. Good, I don't want her to get crushed.

A few minutes pass, and after my eyes begin aching from the flash of all the back-camera selfies I've taken, we're left alone, finally.

Well, sorta. They're still standing a little away from us, watching.

Sean, Brady, and I walk where Ava stands, but suddenly she looks sad again.

“Hey, you okay?” Brady asks.

“Yeah, I'm fine. I'm just a little tired,” she says. “You know, it's been a long day and —” she looks at her watch on her dainty wrist — “it's pretty late. Do you guys need a lift back to the bar, or...?”

“No, that's fine, Ava. You go home and rest,” Sean says.

“Want us to drive you home with your car?” I say because I want to spend more time with her.

“No, that's okay,” she says.

A beat of silence.

“We'll take you to your car, then,” Brady says.

The walk to the car park has none of the energy the night had before we got ambushed. When we get to the Beetle, we place the teddy bears in the backseat.

“So could we get your number?” I say, a little nervously, feeling like I'm in middle school again.

She hesitates before she says, “Sure.”

What was it? Was it the swarming girls? It had to be; we were fine before that.

She punches her number in and then looks up at us with a smile that doesn't quite reach her eyes. “Goodnight. I really had fun. Thank you.”

She climbs into the driver's seat and we stand there in the partial darkness long after she's gone.

Chapter 5

Ava

At a cafe we frequent, I'm having eight a.m. coffee with Kelly, my modelesque, strawberry-blond best friend who's looking colorful in a flowy, floral dress that contrasts with my mournful, tight black sundress. I chew a forkful of pancakes and she curses as she stares at her computer, typing an assignment that's due today.

"It's impossible to find up-to-date sources for my review," she says in frustration. She picks up her steaming cup and takes one huge gulp that seemingly doesn't burn her mouth.

The summer sun is weak as we sit at an outdoor table, people moving quickly to get to work behind us.

Kelly has been dying to know everything about the "little excursion" as she calls it, that I had with three very popular NHL players.

"And not just *any* NHL players," she said over video call once I got home from Wonderland the evening before last, "but Stanley Cup finalists, and also the hottest NHL players, period!"

I've been acting very unconcerned about the whole thing like it's normal to go on an amusement park date with three very large, very gorgeous men. I told her how we hooked up — ("No, we didn't *fuck*," I said hastily when Kelly's eyes increased to the size of light bulbs. "Like, you know, hanging out, getting together") — and how it turned into a night I'll always remember.

She's doing her assignment now so she's given the topic a rest. My brain, however, has not. It's being insufferable about the entire thing.

Muscles.

Deep voices.

And the heights? Someone help me.

I do own a dildo. I didn't need it that much because, well, I had a boyfriend, but I brought it out for the first time in at least five months, and I *used* that thing. Not on the night I got back from Wonderland, no, I was still too shocked by the whole thing to do anything other than stare into space, but yesterday night I went to town after I felt bad about ignoring Noah Hughes' afternoon **We miss you like crazy, Wonder Girl, let's hang again soon** text because I was panicking and didn't know what to say and also because I said no more hockey players, dammit. I just hope my neighbors didn't hear me vibrating my frustrations away because that thing was on maximum performance.

There's funny Brady. There's leading Sean. And there's quiet and sensitive Noah. The way they made me forget all my troubles was downright witchcraft. I keep thinking it's a dream, but there are pictures all over the internet, even news stories about the "new girl spotted with the HCH line at Wonderland". I don't know how they did it, but they already have my name and my age, which would have impressed me if it was someone else, but since it's actually me I'm kind of freaking out. (By the way, my mom, a huge tabloid reader, is *ferally* interested in the whole thing and she's already thinking of wedding bells after I had to tell her and Dad what Will and Angie did, to which Mom confessed she never liked Will (too indifferent) and that she was sadder about Angie than mad, but she comforted me saying if that heartbreak didn't happen, then I wouldn't have met who I ended up meeting).

I take a sip of coffee. The sugary warmth that runs through me is akin to the one I felt when Noah pressed his body to mine, when I held his hand, his rough, callused hand, that would feel amazing touching my —

"Fuck!" Kelly says, attracting glances from the pedestrians behind us.

"What?"

“Apparently the assignment is due at noon, not midnight! I'm telling you, this professor is evil. He probably changed it to fuck with us.” She groans. “It's a group assignment, so I have to go and meet with the people I'm doing it with.”

“Can't you do it online? Video conference calls exist.”

“I know.” She senses the clinginess in my voice. “Hey. You'll be fine, okay? And I'll come over to your place as soon as I'm done and we'll watch *Brave* and get high as fuck.”

“Okay,” I say and, after she hugs me, I watch her tall, elegant form disappear into the rushing crowd.

My only class today is online and later in the day, but I still check the sophomore year group chat for U of T Geology. Apparently, Caden got arrested for messing with the bus, and the whole thing has just become crazy — three hundred unread messages since last night.

Before I get tempted to reply to Noah's read message at the bottom of the screen, I click my phone off and go to the mall next door to get more baking ingredients because I bake in my spare time and I'm pretty good. I don't really need more ingredients but I need to do something that'll get rid of this shitty HCH-withdrawal-mixed-with-depression-and-anger-about-being-cheated-on feeling.

I'm almost at Target, my mind drifting to broad shoulders and impossibly big hands, and the image is so vivid that when I see Brady Hayes ahead of me, I think I must be hallucinating him. When I blink, he's still there and smirking at me, walking quickly in my direction. He's so beautiful that he still doesn't seem real. Light blonde hair, brown eyes and a little dark stubble dotting his square jaw.

“No *fucking* way I see you here when I was just thinking about you, Wonder Girl!” he says loudly.

Before I can process the chances of running into him or the sheer joy I'm worryingly feeling, he's bent over and hugged me, lifting me

into the air. I'm so light to him that he doesn't even grunt with exertion.

"You look great," he says once he puts me down, his eyes moving over my body.

I swallow, the compliment and his wandering eyes filling me with heat. "You too. I was actually kind of thinking of you guys." I feel even hotter when I realized I've revealed too much. "Kind of."

His smirk widens. "You were, huh?"

Fuck, he's so sexy. It should be illegal to be this hot.

"We had a great time," I say.

"Yeah, we did. You know you've been *all* we've been talking about? We're not even talking about game strategies anymore."

That's really flattering.

"Where were you headed?" he says.

"Oh, I was just walking around," I say. I don't even remember where I was going. "Where were you headed?"

"Oh, so you know Game 7 is tomorrow, right, so we're flying down to Chicago in a couple hours."

"Oh, yeah," I say like I haven't been obsessively googling everything related to him.

"So I was just grabbing breakfast after my morning workout," he continues as we begin walking wherever he was going. "I don't have much to do for the next half hour, you got any plans?"

"No —" and I don't know where the rest of my words come from — "but we could go back to my place."

Brady's face doesn't betray anything when he says, "Sure."

I lied when I said I didn't know where the words came from. They came from my vagina.

I know. I know it was just the day before yesterday when I swore off men and hockey players, but I didn't swear off sex. It's just sex. If

I don't get fucked right now, I won't get them out of my mind and my system. It's for a good cause, I tell myself repeatedly.

Without warning, Brady takes my hand in his rough-feeling one. It's then I notice a couple of people watching us, one of them surreptitiously taking a picture.

"You get used to it," he says. We go to the mall basement and I draw in a deep breath when I see the beautiful Ferrari he unlocks.

"So just direct me, Wonder," he says, and the way he says the nickname with such affection makes goosebumps sprout on my skin.

During our drive, I try not to eyefuck him, but I fail. I don't do it obviously, though. I'm side-eyeing him. He, on the other hand, keeps turning his head a full ninety degrees to watch me shamelessly from time to time, especially when we're at a traffic light. I pretend not to notice it but it's making me blush.

"You're as red as a sunset, Wonder," he says with a chuckle.

"It's pretty warm," I say defensively.

He smiles. "Hey, can I just say something?" he says as we speed down the highway so fast I'm afraid we might miss a turn. "I haven't been able to think about anything *at all* but you for the past, what, thirty-six hours?" He glances sideways at me, making my legs clench. "And I'm not kidding."

Brady has this persona of being a laid-back kind of guy, and this is the first time I've seen him look serious.

"I mean, we just met, but *damn*, baby." His voice is low and silky. "You just do something to me."

I swallow at the word 'baby'. "I—" I say, but all I'm doing is stammering.

He chuckles nervously, an anguished look on his face. "Sorry, put way too much on you."

A seasoned fuckboy would say these words to get your guard down and your hopes high. Most of the time you can tell when a guy

is being sincere or not and with Brady I can tell he's being sincere. There's no smirk on his face and a vulnerability has crawled into his eyes. Why do I feel the same? The words he said could apply to me as well.

"I feel the same," I admit.

"You do?" he says.

"Yeah — oh, turn left here!" I shout and though he's speeding, he impressively makes a last-minute swerve without jolting us around. "It's just on the left here." I point at an old high-rise block of apartments, which Brady parks in front of.

I turn to look at him. "I know we just met. But... I feel the same as you, it's like... our souls are connected, aren't they?"

Even though they're hockey players, it's not a coincidence I would meet the three of them on the night I was feeling down and angry and hopeless after getting betrayed, and him on the day he's about to fly out to Chicago.

It feels deliberate.

Brady is looking at me like he can't believe I'm real. He nods, his eyes settling on my lips.

"Come upstairs," I say, in a soft voice.

He nods again, eyes darkening. "I'll go wherever you tell me to go."

There's something about hearing those words, about making a man admit to doing whatever to please you, isn't there? In the elevator, the tension is unbelievable, his hand firmly holding mine. When the doors open, I lead him to my apartment at the far end of the hallway and as soon as I open my door and we're past the threshold, I face him and his mouth crashes on mine.

He kicks the door shut and I don't even have to direct him to my bedroom, he just walks us past the tiny living area with the geology textbooks scattered on the sofa and the coffee table like he's been here before.

His lips taste amazing. They're soft. They're pillowy. It's not a cute kiss at all. It's filled with want and fiery need. His hands are cupping my ass and he squeezes and kneads before placing me on my back on the bed.

For a moment, he just stares at me as his nose is two inches from mine, eyes roving over my face. "Fuck," he growls like he's gone deranged. I stare back at him, marveling at such masculine beauty, running a finger over his wet lips.

"I'm clean and have an IUD," I breathe.

He nods. "I'm clean too."

"I need you, Brady," I say urgently.

His nostrils flare and leaning down on me, he catches my mouth with his. I groan when he shoves his tongue through my lips. My body shivers with lustful anticipation while we taste each other. Then his mouth moves to my neck and bites it. I cry out as he sinks his teeth into my shoulder and soothes it with a hungry kiss. He pulls away but never takes his eyes off me as he takes off his t-shirt, revealing a chest so breathtakingly sculpted that all I do is stare at him for a while with my mouth open.

"Take that dress off for me, Wonder, because if you let me do it, I might rip it off with my teeth and it's a dress I want to see you in a couple more times."

He's so turned on, his voice has gone a little hoarse. I do as I'm told, removing the straps from my shoulders and exposing my breasts.

He sucks in a breath and looks away, running a hand through his hair. "Faster than that, baby," he says. The dress is a little tight, so it takes time to come off and when it does, along with my underwear, he steps towards me, pushing me back on the bed and puts a breast in his mouth, biting hard. I yelp as he sucks and pulls with his teeth.

"So perfect," he mutters as he takes my other breast, kissing and nibbling. "You're unreal."

And neither is he because I can't believe Brady, fucking Brady of the Toronto Icy, is sucking on my breasts in my bedroom. When he bites hard on the nipple again, making me gasp, I know for sure I'm not dreaming. His mouth trails kisses down to my neck and to my lips before he drags me to the edge of the bed and opens my legs wide.

He puts his thumb on my clit and I grip the sheets, biting my lip hard. He moves his thumb in circular motions while kissing my inner thigh.

"Oh... my...", I whimper, the words getting clogged in my throat.

He slips a finger through and groans, "So wet for me. How long was this pussy wet for?" He puts in another finger and I place a hand over my mouth to stifle my cry. "Huh? I bet it's been wet for two nights now."

I want to admit he's right, but my words sound garbled. He moves his fingers in and out, those rough calloused things forcing an orgasm to build in my core. When his tongue touches my pussy lips, I arch my back, drawing in a sharp, hissing breath. He begins to lick and suck on my lips and my clit, the pleasure overwhelming.

"Brady!" I moan.

He growls on my pussy lips and I release, exploding into a million pieces and crying out. He makes a sound of satisfaction and then stands up, leaving me bucking on the bed. He drops his sweatpants to reveal his cock which sticks out heavily and thickly from his huge body. Immediately, my mouth waters and even though the orgasm is ripping through me, I find the energy to sit up. I part my lips and his voice is low and rumbling.

"You want me in your mouth?"

I nod, opening my mouth wider and he pushes himself inside.

"Fuck," he says, throwing his head back. I work him, my fingers finding his heavy balls and stroking them.

“You look so gorgeous with my cock in your perfect mouth, Wonder,” he groans.

I can feel him about to come. I can sense how his muscles are tensing but he rips himself out of my mouth before I can get a mouthful of come, and then bends to plant a hungry kiss on my lips.

“That fucking mouth is amazing but I want that pussy, too.” He bites on the lower lip, pulling, and then gently pulls me back onto the bed. Looking me right in the face, he spreads my legs wide again and places himself at my entrance. He slams into me with one powerful thrust and I yelp again. He gives me time to adjust as my fingernails sink into his tree trunk arms and vast shoulders. A crazed expression is on his face as he's buried to the hilt inside me and when he feels me relax around him, he begins to move. Gently at first, and then hard.

Fuck .

My cries are a crescendo as Brady Hayes fucks me, as he groans and occasionally plants rough kisses on my mouth, my cheek, my neck. He looks nowhere but at my face as his hips move relentlessly, his heavy, muscular weight pounding into me over and over and over again.

“Oh, fuck!” I cry out when the orgasm rips through me, a very violent, full-body reaction that has me on the brink of blacking out while Brady presses his forehead against mine and then groans his release into me.

“Ah, fuck, baby,” he growls as his whole body also shivers in waves that keep coming and coming. When they subside, he kisses me gently on the mouth and then on the nose.

“Shit, Wonder,” he says. “You're fucking unreal.”

“Are you kidding me?” I pant weakly, “you are unreal. How are you here, in my room?”

He chuckles, pulling out of me and lying on his back, bringing me close to his vast chest. I am a limp, sweating mess as we're

breathing loudly and staring at each other.

“Please come with me, with us, to Chicago,” he says.

And just like that, the word hockey comes back in my mind. It had been non-existent as I got my brains fucked out.

I look into his eyes. He has a mole on the bridge of his nose, and it's the cutest thing.

I promised myself I wouldn't do hockey players or get involved in hockey anymore. If common college hockey players are unfaithful, unreliable, and capricious, then NHL finalists are all that times a hundred.

I know if I go to Chicago, my heart will be extremely invested in him, in them. But staying here won't do me good: I'll languish and decay as I think of my treacherous ex and ex-best friend, as I relive the drug-like night at Wonderland, as I nurse my carnal need of Noah, Sean and Brady with my overworked dildo. And also, the opportunity to be seen by Will on TV with the heroes he has a weird love-hate for is honestly too good to pass up.

So when I say, “I'll come to Chicago,”, making him smile so wide I swoon, I've exposed my heart to being shattered.

Chapter 6

Brady

I'm not exaggerating when I say she's made me the happiest man in the world by agreeing to come with us to Chicago. Shit feels like she said yes to a wedding proposal.

I bring my mouth to hers, to those soft lips that wrapped around my cock a few moments ago. Her body was perfect. Great legs, full tits and an ass I hopefully will have more time to appreciate in the future.

I can't stop thinking of the feel of her nipples in my mouth, of the taste of her tongue.

She's wrapped a sheet around herself, and I'm tempted to peel it off and reveal that body, but we really have to get to the airport.

"So, baby, you might need to start packing right now," I say as I stand up, naked. She looks at me in awe, and I flex, making her grin. The way she's looking at me.... this woman and what she does to me.

She sits up and lets the sheet fall. I suck in a sharp breath as she smirks. "How late are we?" she asks.

"We're not *that* late," I say as my cock hardens again.

She looks down at it, biting her lip, and says, "I'm not going to be the one who jeopardizes the Icy's chances of winning the Stanley Cup. I might have to move out of Toronto if that ever gets out."

True. "And I'll come with you," I say.

I get dressed as she slips into her en suite bathroom to take a short shower that I won't join because I'll breed her for the second time and IUDs are not a hundred percent reliable.

When she's done, I help her pack.

"You don't have to take much," I say. "It's just two nights." So she puts some clothes in a small pink bag and we're ready to go. Her neck is covered with hickeys and she dabs a little makeup to hide my teeth.

"I won't bite next time," I tease.

"Liar," she says with a dazzling smile that short-circuits my brain for a second.

She offers me a slice of gin and tonic cake she made and I've really found my soulmate because I'm big on cake and sweet things. She carries two more slices in a carrier because Sean and Noah can't miss how good this tastes.

We speed to the condo and when we get there, her mouth drops open. "You guys live here? Isn't this like one of the best apartment buildings in the city?"

"We're actually thinking of moving and getting something more homely," I say, noticing Sean and Noah haven't come back from working out at the Wesley Arena.

My suitcase is already packed and I take a quick, ice-cold shower, hearing my bros speaking to her in the living area when I come out.

I run into the cap as he rushes into his own bathroom, wolfing down a slice of cake. "Get changed," he demands but he's smiling like an idiot. He'd been beside himself when our Wonder Girl didn't reply to our text and this is the happiest I've seen him ever since *that night*. "We're leaving for Wesley in ten."

Make that five. Sean kicks us out of the place as Noah is still brushing his teeth and speeds us to the arena where the bus that'll take us to the airport is waiting.

The entire team, which includes players, coaching staff, support staff, other personnel, and also family and friends, crowds into the bus. Our other teammates are aware of Ava, not from tabloids or social media, but it's because she's all we've been talking about ever

since we met her so everyone wants to meet the famous Wonder, and the Wonder in question is blushing red as roses.

Ava sits between Sean and me, while Noah sulkily shares a seat with McDonald and Cameron. We're driven to the airport, where it's hell checking in all our equipment and bags and going through security. It's the worst part of traveling and once it's over and we're seated in the plane, I breathe a sigh of relief.

During the flight, we discuss game tactics as we always do. Our head coach, severe-looking Tim Johnson, is speaking, and it's important I listen, so I've got one ear on him, but my eye keeps straying over to where she is.

She's sitting with the team's family members and has struck up a friendship with Cameron, I see, and Lainey, Patel's wife, whose husband is a left defenseman. She's doing good. I look at Sean and Noah, and I also see them glance occasionally in her direction which is crazy because Sean is our most serious and focused player, being the captain and all, and it takes a lot to distract him. He's able to keep his concentration in check, though because he adds to what Head Coach Johnson says as if he wasn't half-paying attention to our Wonder Girl, laughing at something that Lainey said.

"And what do you think, Hayes?" balding Assistant Coach Nelson says. I clear my throat because I wasn't really paying attention, I was reliving for the twentieth time how my cock felt clenched inside Ava's wet, throbbing pussy.

"I think it's great. I have a huge problem, though, with one of their defensemen. Daniels." I bring out my phone to show them a video of the number 43 player I've been studying. "The fucker's hard to get past. His positioning is on point and he's built like a linebacker, more than I am, so it's difficult to protect the puck and separate from him."

Coach Johnson frowns and leans toward me to get a better view of the video.

"Plus he's fast," Noah puts in, glancing in Ava's direction.

“Which he heavily relies on,” Coach Johnson says, looking up from my phone. “He’s easy to take down with more unpredictable moves. What we’ll have to focus on is deceiving him...”

As the minutes of our two-hour flight pass, my one eye is still fixed on Wonder when I notice the flight attendants are being nice to everyone else and being a little cold towards her. I think maybe I’m imagining it but then they ask if the other passengers want a drink, including Cameron who’s right next to her, but conveniently leave her out without even looking at her. She’s the only one who doesn’t have something to drink.

“Hayes,” Assistant Coach Nelson says. “Focus, man.”

“Sorry,” I say. “I just... I’m sorry, what were you saying?”

“I said when you, Campbell and Hughes are attacking, the most important thing is to visualize successful plays.”

“Yeah,” I say, nodding.

I know Ava wants to say something but she’s a guest here and she’s never been in a situation like this and I feel responsible for her since I’m the one who asked her to come. I gotta go defend her.

“Sorry, Coach, could you give me a minute?” I stand up and walk towards the retreating flight attendant. “Hey, so what was that about?”

The flight attendant, Glenda, I think her name is, gives me the wide smile she reserves only for the players, sticking her chest out.

“Hello, Mr. Hayes, are you enjoying your flight?”

“Yeah, it’s going pretty well, except it’s been ten minutes and you haven’t given Ava something to drink. Please do.”

“Oh, *that’s* her name, eh?” Glenda says with a laugh, glancing over my shoulder at where Ava is seated. “I honestly thought it was Wonder, would have been more *unique* and not an everyday name like Ava like most girls. I’ll ask her what she’ll have .”

“Yeah,” I say, walking down the aisle to where Ava and Cameron are sitting. “Please make sure my girlfriend feels welcome.”

Glenda's features become surprised, then politely furious. I guess anyone would be if they'd been pushing out their chest the entire year for nothing.

Cameron widens his eyes, and his mouth falls open. The other wives and girlfriends have also heard and smile at each other in a knowing way that's not malicious at all, but more of a “It's about damn time you got in a relationship” kind of way.

Ava looks up at me and for a moment I think I've screwed this up. I'm referring to her as my girlfriend after knowing her for less than two days. I'm not usually the insecure type, but what if she thinks I'm some possessive creep who's already claiming her? But she smiles at me, a big genuine beautiful smile that tells me I'm fine.

“I'm sorry, I must have skipped you by accident. What will you have to drink?” Glenda asks with professional coldness.

“I thought you'd never ask,” Ava says to Glenda. “I'll have apple juice if you have it, thanks.”

Chapter 7

Ava

The heat running through me is enough to light the entire plane on fire and as I sip my apple juice, I glance at Cameron, who's still looking at Brady in shock, his mouth slightly open.

"What?" I say.

"He just called you his *girlfriend*?" he says, looking at me like I'm not real.

I laugh. "What, he's never had a girlfriend before?"

"The three of them?" He nods in the direction of the huddled players. "You know — Brady, Sean, and Noah — they've *never* had girlfriends before, only, what do you call them, *situation-ships*, at most. And puck bunnies, plenty and plenty of puck bunnies. So this is a big deal, *you're* the real deal."

"Huh." I sit with this piece of information, turning it in my mind. I've known him for less than forty-eight hours, but Brady claiming me as his girlfriend feels so... comforting. So hot. The connection between us is so strong that already being girlfriend and boyfriend doesn't feel weird. In fact, it fills me with fire.

"Tell me again about how you and McDonald met," I say, looking over the huddled teammates. I watch as Brady listens to the assistant coach with a slight frown of concentration on his face. "Tell me about your epic love story."

Cameron grins. He's a makeup artist and he agreed to a makeup date because he said he would just love to work on someone with big eyes that are also hooded like mine.

"If you insist," he says, "though I'm warning you, there will be tears."

After he's done I'm definitely in tears. It's the most beautiful love story of coming out and loving who you want to love.

"Are you inspired?" Cameron says, wiping away a tear. "You know how they work, eh? If you're gonna date Brady, you're gonna also have to date Sean and Noah."

My jaw drops open. "How would that work?"

"It's easy," Cameron says with a shrug. "Sean is yours on Monday, Brady on Tuesday, Noah on Wednesday, and you go on like that. I think. I've never done it before." He winks at me, and I laugh.

The pilot's voice comes on. "Ladies and gentlemen, we are now beginning our descent and preparing for landing."

I put my seatbelt on, and when I look up, I lock eyes with Brady. He grins at me, and I feel some more heat crawling up my neck. He walks away to his seat in the front, and the rest of the huddled group breaks apart. Sean smirks at me, while Noah gives me the thumbs up, which I return. When I look back at Cameron, his smile is even wider.

"See? You'll make it work."

We land at exactly midday in a warm and windy Chicago. We go through the grueling arrival process and by now, any feelings I had of being an intruder have evaporated. I chat with Cameron and Lainey like we've known each other since the very first game of the season as we wait for the bus that'll take us to our lodgings. Once we arrive at the hotel, which is right next to the Otters' Atlantis Arena, Sean turns to me in the reception area, my pink backpack slung over one boulder-like shoulder.

"You weren't included in any of the bookings but we can get a room for you if you want," he says.

"Oh, that won't be necessary," I say. "Didn't you hear? Brady and I are dating, so I'll be sleeping in his room."

"Is that right?" Sean says, eyebrows rising as Brady comes to stand next to me, wrapping an arm around my waist.

"It's been about an hour," I say. "So don't beat yourself up for not knowing."

Brady has a shit-eating grin on as Sean and Noah look at us enviously.

"Well the three of us are sharing a room," Noah says grumpily. "So you'll be sleeping in the same room with your boyfriend and his two teammates."

"I don't mind," I say. "And it's not like I wasn't expecting it. I hear you guys do everything together." I smirk. "Even *share* everything."

I see Noah and Sean's eyes darken as Brady gives an even darker growl. "Fuck yes, we do," he says in my ear as Noah runs a hand across his jaw.

"Let's check-in." He looks at the receptionist. "Hi, how are ya? Our room has an Alaskan king bed, right?"

The receptionist smiles. "As requested."

As we enter the elevator with our bags, my phone rings. It's Kelly and she's sent a screenful of exclamation points after she read my message about my traveling to Chicago with the Icy. Then she sends: **I'm losing my mind! You're living in a fucking romance novel, do you know that? And the trope is insta-love???**

I smile because that's exactly what it is.

Fast burn too I send back with a winking emoji and my phone immediately explodes with texts, which I'll reply to when we've settled because she's going to need all the details.

Our hotel room is massive. And the bed?

"I didn't know they made beds this big," I say. I belly-flop onto it and crawl to the other end, and when I look behind me all the guys are watching me with the same dark looks they gave in the reception area.

I clear my throat. "Really big bed. All four of us can sleep comfortably on it."

Noah snorts. “Not with how Brady sleeps.” He stretches, placing his bag down. “By morning, he’ll be the only one on the bed and the rest of us will be a pile on the floor.”

Then why did they request a big bed? And then it hits me: this is supposed to be for *more* than three people.

Three men and multiple women.

Of course they’re used to having tensomes since women throw themselves at them, but the question is: are they going to have them here? Something tells me they won’t... but still...

“Ava, we have to get to practice. You’ll be fine by yourself,?” Sean says.

I nod. “I’ll just be rolling around this bed. Because I cannot get over the size.”

When they leave, I call Kelly and when she answers, she’s screaming so much I have to hold my phone at arm’s length.

Chapter 8

Sean

“Again!” I yell, and my voice booms across the training rink.

My teammates groan as they get back into position. A big part of being a captain is that you have to get used to your teammates always looking at you like they want to kill you. It's not all it's made out to be.

Sure, there's the power aspect of it, but then I have so many more responsibilities. The responsibility to not get murdered.

Right now, Harris, our right defenseman, is giving me the death stare.

“Look, one more time,” I say. “I know it's perfect already, but we just need to make sure.”

We do the 1-3-1 formation again, gliding across the ice lightning-fast, defensemen and forwards in tandem and it's a beauty. I have really high hopes we can win this.

Still though, these nerves... these nerves aren't a good sign. Each time I visualize the Cup, my heart jolts in my chest.

We're so close.

As my teammates and I wrap up our practice session and head back to the hotel, I think about how far we've come and everything we had to go through. So many injuries, so many doubts, so many practices.

Fuck. I can't let nerves get to me, not now. I need to relax, visit the sauna or something.

“What's up?” Brady says.

He's watching me closely. "I don't know man, I'm just... I just can't believe we've come this far. I mean, being here in Chicago for the final game. It's really sunk in, you know?"

"Yeah," Brady says. "We're gonna do it, man. I know we will."

"Yeah," Noah says, catching up with us. "We got this."

Back at our hotel room, the immediate sight of Ava makes the tension in my limbs lessen. Her brown hair is tied up in a bun as she's lying sprawled on the bed and she's taken off the outfit she'd been wearing for shorts and an oversized t-shirt. She's made herself at home and is the image of relaxation.

"So," she says, "how was practice?"

"Grueling," Noah grumbles.

"Don't be so hard on them," she says with a pout at me. Then in a loud whisper, "I'm kidding, be very hard on them."

"Don't have to ask me twice," I say, sitting on the edge of the bed.

She sits cross-legged on the bed and blurts out, "I want to know more about you guys! Like... where did you grow up? What are your hobbies? And not the Google version, the *real* version. You know, your childhood experiences and stuff. And what you like about the color blue, Noah."

He smiles. "So you've done some research already?" He looks out the window. "Well, I just like how it reminds me of the sky, how open it is. And my childhood in Boston was pretty cool, but I used to hang out with kids I didn't like because I thought they were cool and I wanted to be cool too. They weren't really my friends."

"Yeah, me too," Ava says. "I had someone who I thought was my friend this entire time and turns out she wasn't."

"Damn, that sucks," Brady says. "Nothing worse than being with someone and then them ending up being someone completely different." He studies her closely after seeing her mood change slightly. "How about you? You're obviously from Toronto."

“Born and bred like Sean,” she replies with a smile. “My childhood was great. Great parents, always got me Austin Mahone tickets.”

“Austin Mahone, eh?” I say, raising an eyebrow.

She turns to me. “You know him?”

I shrug. “Thought his music was pretty cool.”

She squeals. “We *have* to talk about him! When we have the time, of course.”

“We have the time right now,” I say.

“Did you ever go to a concert?”

“Nah, I wasn't *that* much of a fan. I'm more into death metal, but I did like *Send It* . Catchy.”

“That's probably my... third favorite song,” she says decisively.

The minutes pass by. She's a baker and she promises to bake us a Neopolitan cake in our favorite flavors: velvet for me, vanilla for Brady and chocolate for Noah. Brady, originally from Sacramento, talks about losing our twelve-year-old collie, Sady eight months ago and it makes her tear up. He talks about the time he and his family went on a trip to Italy when he was nine and how he got lost for two days in the wilderness.

“Yeah, it was pretty traumatic,” he says. “I came across a boar and it charged me but I threw a rock at it and it ran away.”

“I feel like that's something that should be on your Wikipedia page,” she says, horrified.

We talk about how we got into hockey and when I mention the hockey academy I attended as a kid, she says, “That's where my ex went. My dirty, lying, cheating ex.”

She says the last sentence so damn viciously, the three of us flinch.

Noah eyes her cautiously. “You, uh, wanna vent?”

She takes a deep breath and says, "Oh, I do," and she tells us everything, how he cheated on her with her best friend, how he's always been uncaring and distant, and how he was an lcy fan and he didn't get drafted last year by us, or any other team.

"I could remember him," I say. "What's his name?"

"William Lerner." She types something on her phone and shows me a picture of him.

"Yeah, I remember him." I scowl. "He's lucky he didn't join us because we would've made it a living hell. Seriously though, you didn't deserve that, Ava. You deserve love and care, attention, and someone who's devoted to you."

She blushes. "Thanks." A comfortable beat of silence. "What about you guys? Any epic love story I'm supposed to know about?"

"Nah. You wanna change that?" Brady says, smirking.

She blushes even more and looks at the floor. "What do you guys see in an everyday girl like me?"

"There's *nothing* every day about you, Ava," Noah says almost impatiently.

We stare at her and my eyes land on her perfect bare legs, her cute toes. "Shit, this conversation just made my nerves disappear," I say, stretching. "You know, at practice, I was feeling nervous but talking has eased the tension from me. So thank you for that, Ava. A strategy I need to discuss with the rest of the team and coach just flew into my mind." I take my phone out and text something on the team group chat. **Meet in Harris's room in 10. Important strategy I want to discuss.**

Noah groans. "I gotta take a shower first. Smell like a fucking locker room."

"Don't care, just want you in Harris's room in ten minutes," I say.

I walk over to Ava and give her a light kiss on the mouth. Her lips are so sweet and so soft and she looks up at me with surprise and

lust that just makes me want to taste her some more. "I'll see you later?"

"Yeah, okay," she breathes out.

Chapter 9

Ava

It's been seven minutes and Noah is still in the shower. Sean seems like he takes his strategy talks real serious and I don't want Noah to get in trouble, so I'm getting anxious as I lie on the bed, fiddling with my phone. He's been singing the entire time in a very beautiful baritone that's literally shaking the entire hotel room and it's a popular song I find myself humming along to.

When another minute passes, I can't take it any longer so I sit up from the bed and look at the door as if that'll make him come out of there right now. But he doesn't. I call out his name. He's still singing. I stand up and walk towards the door, steam floating from the gaps and I knock on it gently, knocking again louder when there's no answer, his loud singing and the loud shower make it impossible for him to hear me.

I obviously can't go in. I mean, he's probably naked. But when another minute passes, where I'm in anxious agony by the door, I have no choice but to open it just a crack. The sound of the shower and his singing become louder, and I yell, "Noah, you're gonna be late for the meeting!"

"Huh?" he says. I open the door a little wider, about to repeat myself and – oh, my....

The shower's still running, but he's not in there. He's standing by the mirror, holding a tube of toothpaste, which he's made into a makeshift microphone. Butt naked.

His dark hair is wet, and a light film of body fur covers his entire torso and legs, some on his arms, too. I find myself squinting to see better through the steam and when I realize what I'm doing, I stop with a start.

“Sorry!” I say. Then, again, “You’re going to be late for the meeting!”

“It’s fine,” he says, unconcerned.

My eyes automatically move downwards to *the place* .

It is *big* .

It is *thick* .

And I think it’s darker than the rest of his body because of pigmentation, but then I realize it’s ink.

Other than a tattoo of a dragon along his diaphragm, the only other tatted part on him is his big, thick cock.

“You wanted to take a shower?” he says when I’m still standing there.

“Yes! I mean —” I don’t even know what I’m saying. “Yes. I do want to.”

I took a shower when they were at practice, but I can always shower again, eh? A person can never be too clean, right? I’m not even aware of my actions, I just know in the next couple of seconds, the oversized t-shirt and shorts I’m wearing are on the floor and I’m only in my bra and my panties.

Noah is watching me, and I will myself to move forward. I am on fire, turned on so much that my legs are wobbling slightly.

If this is just a trip to Chicago and our... *relationship* doesn’t work out, I still need to get all of them out of my system, not just Brady.

I need to fuck all three of them.

“You need help?” he drawls. “You look like you’re gonna fall and the floor is wet.”

I don’t answer him. I make my way to the shower, remove my underwear, and put myself under the hot stream of water. It’s like it melts away all my nervousness, and my entire body relaxes. I give out a moan of pleasure and when I open my eyes, he’s leaning

against the sink, watching me, inked cock hard and pointing directly upwards.

I look around for soap, feeling the wetness gather in my core. There's some on the floor in a bottle, and I apply it to my hands, then begin soaping myself slowly. I start with my neck, and then my shoulders, and arms. I see his jaw tighten so I move to my breasts, taking time on them. He runs a hand across his jaw, looking up at the ceiling with a slight smile and shake of his head, his cock bobbing up and down, looking painfully hard. I then move to my stomach, and then to my legs, bending down.

"Soap below your belly button, baby," he says in a tone so commanding, I just *have* to obey.

I take the bottle of soap and apply some more on my hand. Slowly, I rub the soap just above my mound and just touching myself near my pussy makes my breath catch.

"Go lower," he says, and my hand slides down until it's over my mound. "Lower."

Now I'm cupping my pussy.

"Rub," he commands, and I do so. His hand finally grabs hold of his cock but he doesn't jerk it, he just circles the tip.

"Want you to keep rubbing your pussy while you rub your tits with your other hand," he says, and I obey, getting some soap which has lathered well over my labia and transferring it to my breasts.

"Fuck," he says, as he gives the head of his penis a little squeeze. "Turn around." And I do. I hear him mutter, "Perfect ass."

I hear his footsteps behind me, and he stops maybe like two inches behind me. The room is warm, it's full of mist, but I can feel the heat of his body. I feel him bend over and get the tube of soap. I hear the squirt as he applies it to his hand, and then I feel his hand, rough and callous, on my back. I almost moan, but I bite my lip to keep it in. He rubs in circular motions, his thumbs pressing into my skin. A moan does escape then, and he sucks in a low breath. His

hands go lower and lower until they're just over my butt, kneading. I find myself slightly bending over, but he brings me back up, straightening me gently, then his hands cup my ass.

The heat of his skin on mine is making me pant a little. He squeezes my cheek, then gives it a light smack. I whimper, and he smacks again, harder.

He gets on his knees and then spreads my ass, and his first lick drives out a full-blown moan for me. He wraps his arm firmly around my thighs, keeping me in place as he licks my asshole. I place one hand on his head, the other on the wall of the shower, as he kisses and groans, tasting me.

"Oh fuck, it feels so good," I whine, and he makes a growl of acknowledgment, moving his tongue faster.

He then turns me around and has me lean against the shower wall. He spreads my legs and brings his face in, his tongue circling my clit. I moan, arching off the wall as his mouth encloses my pussy and begins to suck.

He's going to be late. He's going to be late...

"Fuck," I whine. He's looking up at me, his eyes darkened and focused on my reaction. His tongue is relentless, and when an orgasm tears through me, he stands, turns me around again and places two fingers in me, wrapping an arm around me to support me. He makes come-hither motions with his fingers inside me, driving cries out of me, then eases his cock in. I let out a long moan, and he begins to fuck me gently. His hands cup my breasts as he increases his pace until he's fucking me so hard the slapping sounds in the bathroom are thunderous.

"Fuck, baby, you're so tight around my cock, it's unbelievable," he says in my ear.

"And. Your. Cock. Is. Really. Stretching. Me. Out," I moan, in between his thrusts. "Oh, fuck."

“Yeah. Take that, cock,” he says in my ear. “You're so good at taking it, baby.”

He slaps my ass some more as he increases his pace, and my back arches and the orgasm starts to build up again. I come violently, my body jerking all over the place and he holds me firmly in place as he fucks me, thrusting a few more times before he pulls his cock out and spills on the shower floor, groaning.

“Fuck, yes, baby.” He throws his head back, still supporting me with one hand. He turns off the shower and puts me over his shoulder, grabbing a towel. In our hotel room, he makes me sit on the edge of the bed and begins to dry me off as I shake with post-orgasms. Then he lifts me and places me on the bed, lying down with me.

He kisses me on the mouth. The first kiss he's given me. It's not hungry. It's soft and gentle, almost apologetic but still hot as a brand. Then he kisses my neck and then my shoulder and each kiss is hot like a brand. He kisses my breasts and my sternum. He trails down my stomach, hovering just over my pussy, driving me crazy...

“I love how smooth your skin is,” he mutters, running a finger across my neck. I watch his beautiful face and large green eyes, how he's looking at my skin with genuine amazement like he's reviewing a specimen in a lab.

“I'd love to do this all day,” he says, “but Sean is gonna kill me, and head coach Johnson is gonna murder me.”

Oh, fuck, the meeting! “I was trying to get you to go there, and I made things worse!”

He chuckles. “I won't get in trouble.” He stands up and my body already misses his warmth, his mouth. He gets dressed, watching me naked on the bed with such lust, I think he's going to come back and spread my legs, which I want him to, but he runs a hand across his strong chin in mild frustration, looks away, and says, “I'll see you soon,” before leaving.

Chapter 10

Noah

It's a good thing we're not going back to practice because I hate being on the ice after I've fucked.

I can still feel the come dripping from my cock as I make my way to Harris' room. My entire body is now sluggish in that way only coming makes it sluggish. I want to curl up on the bed with Ava and take a light nap or maybe talk some more. The chat we had earlier was the most we've had with any girl. Most girls we've been with are so focused on impressing us sexually that there's no chance of any meaningful conversation, anyway.

Fuck, I already miss the feel of her skin. I didn't even have time to pay attention to her tits or properly eat her ass out and suck her toes. That's the kind of treatment she deserves after having that sorry excuse of a boyfriend.

When I get into Harris's room, everyone turns to look at me, and from the expressions on their faces, you'd think I'd committed some heinous crime.

I put my hands up. "I'm sorry, everyone." But I know that's not gonna cut it.

"Hughes," Coach Johnson says.

That's all he says. Scary.

"Sorry, Coach, shower ended up taking a couple more minutes than I intended."

Coach looks at Sean, a frown on his face. Sean is in charge of all of us, and I kind of feel bad because my being late is a reflection on him. My best friend crosses his arms and from the way he's looking at me, he knows where I was just by analyzing my body language.

“Give me fifty,” he says, turning away from me as they continue their discussion. I drop to the floor — shit, that was the hardest I’ve ever come because my arms are shaking.

I wanted our Wonder Girl so bad I was afraid I fucked her too hard. At least I’d done some aftercare, but I didn’t take my time like I wanted to.

“Twenty-five, twenty-six, twenty-seven,” I count loudly.

Perfect, perfect body, perfect skin. Perfect pussy. Perfect toes...

“Forty-two, forty-three.” In my plank position, I look down at my cock and it’s hard again and my slightly wet and very sensitive head is touching the floor through my pants each time I lower myself. How am I going to get up? Doesn’t matter, really. We’re all guys in here, we all get randomly hard.

It seems like Coach hasn’t let it go. “We can’t afford to have any distractions,” he says seriously when I stand up. “We’re playing in less than twenty-four hours. This is Game 7 of the Stanley Cup Finals, right? The Otters know everything about us because they’ve played us for six games. We can’t make any mistakes, and mistakes are avoided when we’re serious about strategy meetings.”

“Yes, Coach,” I say. His lecture just tells you how high the stakes are right now. Sometimes it blows my mind how we made it this far. The entire season is a blur. I don’t even remember half of it.

Coach draws in a big breath. “I’m sorry, but if Ava or Wonder, as you call her, is causing distractions, then we might have to change things. Can’t she go somewhere, for the time being, take a little tour of the city?”

“No.” Sean, Brady and I say at the same time, which prompts whoops and catcalls from the rest of the guys.

“Coach,” Sean says over the noise. “It’s my fault Hughes was late and I promise he won’t step out of line again.”

“It’s not just Noah,” Coach says. “The three of you could barely concentrate on the plane, you kept looking over at her. I’m just

saying it's a bad time to be... newly in love. The honeymoon phase is all-consuming and it's just not a good time right now."

"We've been playing better ever since we met Ava, though," Brady says. "The morning practice session after the night at Wonderland was stellar. Everything was just on point. The bros can vouch for us."

Patel shrugs. "These assholes were unstoppable yesterday and even today during practice."

Harris confirms this. "What Patel said. There's nothing that motivates you more than a girl you want to impress."

Sean, Brady, and I look at Coach, waiting for his verdict as he runs a hand on his temple, a habit of his.

"I was feeling nervous earlier, eh," Sean admits, "and we talked to her and...." He makes a motion of something leaving his body. "I'm telling you, Coach, if she goes —"

"Fine. Whatever." Coach kneads his temple even harder. "We need to discuss all the things we need to, all our weaknesses, our power plays, before the dinner."

Oh right, there's a dinner later today for team bonding purposes. We didn't tell Ava, and I don't think she brought a dress.

"We're wasting time," Coach continues. "Get over here, Hughes." He turns to McDonald who's typing on his phone. "McDonald, share with us your views about the last match and how we can improve."

"Sure," he says, pocketing his phone and it's then I notice my dick has completely gone limp at the thought of Ava being separated from us.

Chapter 11

Brady

"I'm just saying," I say, as we head back to our room. "Daniels is fast, and just too fucking big and — what's the other defenseman called? Didn't you go to school with him?" I say to Sean.

"Nah, we just stayed in the same neighborhood," he says. "Peterson."

We open the door to our hotel room to find our wonder seated at the desk, writing something on paper. Her brow is furrowed and she looks like she doesn't want to be disturbed. She doesn't even notice us until we're halfway into the room, jumping about a foot in the air.

"Oh, fuck!" she says, prompting chuckles from the three of us.

"What are you doing, baby?" I say, leaning down to give her a light kiss.

She turns deep red. "Oh, just writing some notes. You know, geology stuff." She holds up a paper and sings, "About andesite and pumice."

"Are those rocks?" I ask.

She nods. "I like andesite because it's like my surname."

"Your surname is... Anderson?" Sean says like we didn't find out her full name the night we met her.

She nods. "Good guess!"

"I was gonna go with Andrews," I say. "Tell us more about these rocks."

"As much as I want to hear about andesite and pumice," Sean says, taking his phone out and typing something, "we have a team dinner to prepare for."

She perks up at this, her pretty eyes widening. “Wait, do you mean I need, like, a dress or something?”

The bite mark I left on earlier is now visible on the base of her neck as the oversized tee hangs loose on her frame. Her hair is wet, so is Noah's, and I chuckle to myself.

“But I didn't bring a dress for dinner,” she says.

“Don't worry, we can always go buy one,” Noah says. “Pretty sure there's a shop for dresses close by. And even if there isn't, he'll know where to find one.”

“Who? she asks before realization comes on her face. “Cameron. Right, so is it like an event or... ?”

“It's just a regular dinner downstairs in one of the halls or something,” I say.

Sean looks at his phone and it rings. “Cam, yeah. Ava doesn't have a dress for the dinner, and —”

“I'm on my way,” Cam says, interrupting, and hanging up.

“He's Superman when it comes to these things.,” Noah says.

All four of us jump when there's loud knocking at the door right that second. “Damn, isn't he like on another floor?” I say, opening it to reveal Mr McDonald.

“Where is she?” he says, not unlike a feral cat. I step to the side, raising my hands, letting him pass.

He holds out a hand to her. “Let's go on an adventure!” he says. “It'll be fun!”

Sean says, “Just make sure not to take long, eh, because we have to be downstairs in about... an hour. I know how carried away you sometimes get.”

Cameron waves a hand at him. “We'll do whatever we want,” he says, taking the black card Noah gives him. Ava removes her oversized shirt and shorts in the bathroom and wears jeans and a

grey top. The two of them fly out of the room while Sean goes to take a shower.

“To save time so much,” Noah says to me, yawning like he’s run a mile, “both of you should shower at the same time.”

“And get seduced?” I say. Though there’s much love between the three of us, it’s not like that. Last year there was a time we got drunk and, uh, experimented on each other but it just didn’t do anything for us, which is disappointing because sometimes when you’re horny and don’t have access to pussy, your mate’s mouth or hand doesn’t look so unappealing. But there’s no faster way to get limp dick.

Ava and Cam come back from their adventure just as I finish showering. From the bathroom, I hear her speaking excitedly as Cam hypes her up. I gotta see this phenomenon for myself, so I quickly finish brushing my teeth and go out without properly rinsing but I’m disappointed to see her not wearing the dress, just showing it off, holding it in front of her body.

“I bet you’re going to look perfect in that,” I say.

“She will,” Cameron says. “I thought it was gonna take us more than the time we were allocated to by Cap over there, but literally anything suits her. Like she could literally wear a sack and it would look *good* on her.”

“That’s our girl,” Noah says approvingly.

We quickly change into our tuxedos and I see Ava checking us out stealthily. When my eyes meet her, I smirk knowingly, and she smirks too, looking away.

Dirty, dirty girl.

“You three: out!” Cameron says to Sean, Brady, and me.

“Don’t you have to go and get ready, too?” I tease, eyeing his simple shorts and beach shirt. “I know you take fashion risks or whatever, but come on, Cam —”

“Out!”

Downstairs, the dining hall we're supposed to be having our buffet in has been decorated with the red and blue of the Toronto Icy.

McDonald, Patel, Coach, and the rest of the team are huddled at one table, all dressed in suits, the chandelier above casting warm, yellow light on them.

"... don't stick so much next time," Assistant Coach Nelson is saying. "Just try to keep to yourself, otherwise another brawl'll start, for fuck's sake."

This is what hockey is about. The strategy talks are endless, and sometimes we overdo it to the point it gets confusing. I sigh, sit and listen, looking at the notebook that has a rink and several arrows drawn on it while the women and children are at their tables, chatting and laughing. When they suddenly gasp, I fucking fire up, thinking a crazed fan of the Otters has entered the room, but no, something much more lethal has.

Ava fucking Anderson, fucking wonder of the world.

She's glittering, she's glowing. The black dress with no straps is tight, but it flares at the bottom. Her hair is in a tight, sleek ponytail that's just begging to be pulled. Cam has done her face, enhancing her beauty.

She's fucking breathtaking.

Fuck, I'm so lucky I got to be inside her earlier.

She stands at the entrance for a bit. One of the kids, Harris's, yells, "You look so beautiful!" and everyone laughs.

"Thanks, you too!" Ava calls back.

Martin and Taylor are staring at her a little too much for my liking. I'm being ridiculous. But I don't know, it just bothers me. She's fucking ours. And when another man looks at her, I don't know, man.

Don't be an insecure asshole, Brady.

"Okay, everyone at their tables," Coach says. "We'll continue later, possibly after dinner."

I go to a table reserved for us three forwards and Ava but they've misspelled her name and put an E at the beginning.

"You look fucking great," Sean says, moving wide eyes up and down her body. I suppose that's what my eyes are like too, because damn, I've never seen anything more fucking elegant.

"Thank you, Sean," she says, doing a little spin.

Noah just swallows and runs a hand over his jaw. He pulls back her chair.

"Thank you," she says. We all sit down, staring at this wonder before us.

She giggles shyly. "Makeup and styling done by Cameron, isn't he a beauty?"

"Speaking of..." As I watch Cam come through the doorway, dressed in a pink t-shirt and pale green suit, my eyes land on Martin and Taylor at the next table, still looking at Ava.

"Come on guys," I say to them. I say it in a joking voice, but I'm not joking. So I try to laugh it off, but they're still ogling our girl.

"Yo," I say louder, and they look at me again, and then look away, muttering something about how it's not that deep. I open my mouth to say something back but over their shoulders I see Coach looking at me sternly.

I close my mouth, feeling like a reprimanded child. He doesn't want tension between the team and the point of this dinner is to bond and therefore create better chances of us winning tomorrow.

Still, though, I'm not gonna tolerate anyone, not even my teammates, looking at our girl for a beat too long, team bonding be damned.

Patel, who'd been watching the whole thing with raised eyebrows, jumps up before Sean and Noah get into the fray, tapping a spoon against a glass. "Attention, everyone! Attention! Thank you. Well, we're here. The final game of the Stanley Cup Finals!"

Everyone cheers.

"It's been a rough year, but also a fortunate one. So, before we start eating and dancing and get our asses to bed, we just want the team to say a few words about what they're grateful for. Thank you."

When he sits down, Harris stands and says he's grateful for the friendships he's made in the team. McDonald says he's forever grateful for having found love with the right person and how it's still going strong. Miller says he's grateful for his wife giving him twins in the past year while Assistant Coach Nelson is thankful his wife beat Stage 3 cancer.

And then when it comes to me, I say I'm grateful for my parents, and my sisters, and then I look at Ava.

"I'm grateful for this girl who's sitting across from me. I've known her for less than forty-eight hours, no wait, it's about forty-eight hours now," I say, looking at my watch to a chorus of chuckles, "but yeah. We met at a bar, which sounds pretty typical, but... typical situations sometimes create the most atypical love stories, don't they? And I'm grateful for that."

"I'm grateful for that too," Sean says. "You're a never-seen-before wonder in our lives, Ava."

Ava's grinning and there are tears in her eyes, and I resist an urge to walk across the table and kiss them away.

"Here's hoping our relationship blossoms," Noah says, his hand enclosing hers.

The food is brought out and after we've filled ourselves, some of the players begin to dance with their wives and girlfriends. Ava dances with Sean to Austin Mahone playing from her phone as Noah and I watch their chaotic, but entertaining moves.

A few minutes after nine, Coach's voice booms across the room. "Bedtime! But first, a two-minute discussion!"

When the discussion is over, we trudge back to our rooms, Ava walking ahead with Sean, Noah and I trailing right behind them. I'm

not getting any sleep with the image of that dress in my mind, because right now she's swinging her hips, her ass jiggling, and the only thing I want is to bury my face between those cheeks, licking her until she can't take it anymore.

Chapter 12

Ava

A regular girl from Toronto who's studying geology has found herself the center of a speech. How does she react?

She almost bursts into tears.

No man has ever talked about me the way Brady, Sean, and Noah did and I'm grateful. I'm grateful I could come to Chicago and meet so many great people because I would have been at home, wallowing in depression, thinking about Will, Angie and where I went wrong. I'd be drinking and eating homemade croissants, walking like a zombie in my small apartment but I'm here in Chicago, having the time of my life.

"I'm grateful for you guys too," I say to Sean. "I know I didn't get a chance to say something, but I was in a really bad place when you found me back home in Toronto." I smile. "Thank you."

"You're welcome," they say.

"And anytime you need anything from us, you ask us, okay?" Sean says.

"We'll do anything for you," Noah says from behind us. "And that's a promise."

I know we're in Chicago literally for hockey, but for a hot second, I forget they're hockey players.

Maybe I was wrong. Maybe they're not all like that. Maybe Will is just like that.

Also, there's no way Will would be able to look as good as they do in these suits. Sean has his shirt unbuttoned and it's driving me crazy. I've already had multiple orgasms today, but honestly, I wouldn't mind more with the way they're dressed.

I've tasted Noah and Brady. I want a taste of Sean too. In the elevator, I can't help but glance sideways at his open shirt. Our eyes meet but I don't look away. He just smirks at me like he knows exactly what I want... and he's gonna give it to me.

The captain takes hold of my hand and leads me to our room, the other two lagging to get a good view of my ass from the way they kept looking at me like I was tastier than the duck we just had. Anticipation crawls through my skin as Sean moves with such purpose, my heart beating in tune with our steps.

We walk into the cool darkness of our room. I stand next to the bed and have an urge to remove my heels, but something tells me to keep them on. Something tells me Sean wants me in heels.

He takes off his jacket and places it on a chair. He rolls up his sleeves. The anticipation is electric, making my skin itch. I need his mouth on me, his hands everywhere. I need his cock inside me and I'm ready to do what he wants. Whatever the captain orders, I'm doing it.

"Lie on the bed," he says, his voice a dark growl.

I do as I'm told, quivering slightly, climbing the bed with my shoes on. Brady and Noah enter the room and stand by the doorway, watching.

Sean places his hands on the bed and stalks to me. When his face is over mine, he lowers himself and kisses me lightly. Then he pulls away slightly and I go after him, needing more. He's teasing me, torturing me.

"Please," I say. He smiles and brings his full lips down to me with more force. I can tell he's holding back his hunger. It's a quivering current on his hot skin...

When both of us have had our fill of tasting each other's mouths, he pushes me down on the bed.

He slowly hikes up my dress, watching my face, watching my reaction.

I'm biting my lip to prevent myself from moaning with anticipation, and when my dress is high enough to expose most of my legs, but not my underwear, he buries his face *there* , taking one, hot lick.

I cry out, as he presses his face so hard against my pussy, inhaling. With each deep inhale, he lashes out his fiery tongue, making me grip the sheets and bite my lip harder.

"She's so responsive," I hear Noah mutter with pleasure while Brady growls something inaudible.

Sean brings his fingers into the fray, but they don't go for the entrance I expect. His thumb is at my ass, and he wets it with his tongue flicking at my pussy before pushing it through.

The groan I let out is embarrassing and I hear Noah laugh softly, darkly. Sean begins to fuck my ass with his thumb as his tongue goes full force on my clit. I'm thrashing on the bed when he commands, "Brady, come suck her tits, but don't take her dress all the way off."

I hear, not see, Brady come towards us because my vision is just blackness as I come. Resurfacing slightly, I feel Brady's hot mouth hang over my neck as he lowers the zip under my arm. When he exposes my nipples, I know they're hard as fuck. He begins to suck on one, sinking his teeth in my skin as Sean continues to attack my pussy and ass with his tongue and thumb.

"Noah, come suck her toes," Brady says in between electric nibbles. "We want our girl to hit a higher plane."

Sean takes my heels off and instantly something hot and wet touches my toes.

Brady's right, I'm about to float out of this body. Fuck, I had no idea it was possible to feel like this, it's like I'm being pulled in several different directions. Brady is aggressively attacking my tits. Sean is devouring me down there, and my toes are being kissed and licked by Noah as he massages my sensitive soles.

I fall apart again, seeing a more intense black at the edges. I place a hand over my mouth, but I hear Sean say, "Let it out baby, don't worry about any of that," and when he shoves his fingers deep inside my pussy, my hand flies from my mouth and into his luscious dark hair.

His wet mouth moves from my pussy. "Now, you two to watch while I fuck her," he says in that deep voice full of lust.

I feel Sean peel my dress off, and I lie in the center of this huge bed, quivering with the orgasms wrung from my body.

He helps me to get on all fours and my ass is in the air. I feel so vulnerable and Sean comes up from behind me, placing his cock at my entrance. He's still fully dressed, the sleeves of his shirt still pulled back. His cock juts out from the zipper, thick and bending slightly to the side and I have an urge to touch and suck it, but he slams it inside of me before I can.

I cry out and lock eyes with Noah seated on the bed in front of me, Brady next to him, their cocks out, both bulging and pulsing. They're stroking them as they watch their captain fuck the shit out of me.

"Good girl," he groans as I arch my back even more, giving him a better view of my asshole, which he sticks his thumb in. I bury my mouth into the mattress, basically screaming as Sean fucks me and as Brady and Noah praise me about how I'm being such a good girl, taking Sean's big cock hard and fast with a thick thumb up my ass.

The fucking goes on, relentless, passionate, the room full of grunts, moans, and the sound of a few slaps on my ass.

"You have such a perfect ass," Sean growls. "I could fuck it all night."

I would have said his cock feels so amazing stretching my pussy out but the words would just come out as garbled whimpers. I take that cock until I release again, fire coursing through my veins.

Sean comes a few minutes later, releasing into me with a roar, and when he pulls out, Brady and Noah grunt in unison.

For a few seconds, there's panting in the air. Brady gives a breathless laugh. "How many times can one person come in a day? Seriously."

I can't talk. I can't even lift a finger. Sean carries me into the bathroom and lowers me gently on the toilet seat and when I'm done, he carries me back. The other two are cuddled in bed and I'm placed in the center where it's warmest and most comfy. They each give me a light kiss on the forehead before we fall asleep, exhausted.

When I wake up, I'm all alone in the hotel room, my body still aching deliciously from last night's orgasms and I can't lie for a hazy, sleepy second, I think I've been abandoned. But then sense creeps back into my mind.

Hockey players wake up extremely early.

The door opens just then and the three of them march through. "She's up. Good morning, beautiful," Brady says, "you're a fucking champ, you know that?"

I grin. "A champ at taking dick, you mean?"

They laugh.

Noah says, "We're getting breakfast at Denny's if you wanna come. If you're too tired or sore, we can order room service for you."

"No, I'll come," I yawn. "Let's spend as much time together as we can."

They grin. "No better way to spend the morning of game 7," Sean says.

I change into a short skirt, tight T-shirt, and some tennis shoes and we walk to the Denny's down the road. The place is full of

people wearing the blue and red jerseys of our team and I suppose a lot of fans are staying in hotels close to the arena.

We order a very basic breakfast of eggs and bacon.

“Always on game day, we have a very basic breakfast. It's a ritual of ours,” Noah explains.

“Ah! Hockey players and their superstitions,” I say. I’m very familiar with them, of course. Will’s were outlandish; one of them involved not wearing underwear the day before a game.

Just as the waiter arrives with our food, two girls approach our table. They’re around my age. One is blond and one has curly orange locks. Pretty. They smile dazzlingly at the HCH line.

“Hi, we just wanted to say we're really big fans, as you can see!” the blond girl says. They point at their jerseys: the blond girl is wearing Noah’s number 31 and the redhead Sean’s number 55.

“And we were just wondering if you guys would like more company!” the redhead girl is saying. “You know, to even things out, since there's one girl.”

I'm smiling with surprise, but inside, anger, protectiveness and jealousy course through me. There will be *no* evening things out. I'm the only one. But of course, I don't say these things, I just keep smiling and look at the guys.

It's their call.

Suddenly, my heart starts racing. A very hockey-player move would be to give the girls their numbers and ask them to come join us in their hotel room later. I look at the size of the girls' boobs. They're definitely hockey players' type.

“Sorry girls, but we have all the woman we need here,” Noah says. Sean and Brady make sounds of assent.

The girls look surprised. “Oh. Oh okay, well, it was nice talking to you,” the red-haired girl says. Before they go, they throw me a look I can't quite read.

“Go on,” Sean says. “You were talking about volcanic rocks and shit.”

“Right.” I dig into my food and continue, as red as the ketchup bottle and as giddy as a drunk, and when we're done, Noah takes a selfie of all four of us and posts it to his Instagram.

“Any caption ideas?” he says. We all give suggestions and they're all lame, so he just captions it: **game day with the team** .

We all know popular men don't post girls on their socials unless it's serious. I try not to grin like an idiot, but I can't help it.

“What?” Noah says.

“Nothing.”

“Look. It's not a bad caption. I mean, pretty bland, but it's not horrible like the ones Brady kept suggesting.”

“They were funny,” Brady says. “Hilarious even.”

I excuse myself to go to the bathroom and as I'm washing my hands by the sink, the bathroom door opens and the two girls enter.

They act like they've come in here to freshen up, but just as they're about to leave, they turn to me.

“How did you get them wrapped around your finger so much?”

I turn to look at them. “Excuse me?”

“I know you from campus,” the redhead says. “I've seen you with Will Lerner.”

“Okay?” I say, confused by her almost accusatory tone.

“Why can't you convince them to let us join you?”

“Because I don't want to?” I say. “And they said they weren't interested, didn't they?”

That makes them smirk.

“She thinks they're in love with her, eh,” the redhead says to her blonde friend, who sizes me up.

“You know they're notorious about not settling down, right?” she says. “And they've broken so many girls' hearts that way.”

“How would you know?” I ask.

The blonde one looks at me like I'm stupid. “Because everyone in Toronto knows about their reputation. Sometimes, I've heard, they like to fuck five girls at once.”

“And you're telling me this... Why?” I say.

“We're just warning you, you're nothing but a long-term puck bunny to them, and in a few days they'll get bored of you.”

I shrug. “Okay.”

I don't believe that, of course. I trust them.

They wouldn't do that to me. Not after yesterday. Not after the way they held me as I fell asleep last night. It's all bullshit. These girls are just mad they got turned away, and I would be mad too if I was them, but I wouldn't take it out on the wrong person.

The girls leave. I wash my hands for a moment too long, looking at my reflection. My lips are swollen from all the kissing and biting, they look nice and full. My skin is glowing and I pull my hair back from my face, truly seeing the beauty the guys see.

I trust them.

When I come out of the bathroom, I see all three of them looking towards me, worried.

“Did they bother you?” Noah says when I sit back down.

“No, they didn't, we just had a little girl talk, that's all.”

When we leave, I'm holding hands with both Sean and Brady.

I trust them.

Chapter 13

Sean

"This is the biggest argument we've ever had," Brady says.

"Second biggest," I say. "The biggest was about what we should text to Ava. We spent a good hour trying to figure that out."

"Okay, we need to wrap this up," Brady says. "The game's in a few hours."

"Come on," Noah says, "it's really not that deep."

"If it's not that deep," I say, "she shouldn't wear your jersey then."

We're headed back to our hotel room, coming from a meeting in the Coach's room. "Let me present my argument," Brady says. "She fell in love with me first, so I think she should wear my jersey."

"She fell in love with you first, how?" I say. "I'm the one who broke free from the crowd at Benjamin's bar and chased after her like they do in romantic comedies. So if she probably fell in love with someone, it's probably me."

Brady snorts. "I'm the one who made love to her first."

"You sure you made love to her?" Noah says. "You didn't fuck the shit out of her?"

"What's the difference?" Brady says.

"Anyway," Noah says, shaking his head, "it should be me. She fell in love with me first because we shared a special moment at Wonderland when she held my hand."

"Oh, right," Brady says. "She held your hand as you relived your childhood trauma. Now, I'm not making fun of your trauma," he says, quickly holding up his hands, "but that doesn't count as falling in love. More of a therapy session than anything."

"What does, then?"

"I don't think y'all get it," Brady says. "She *invited* me into her apartment! I didn't suggest it, *she* did."

"Okay, okay," I say when their voices get too loud. "I think she should wear my jersey because I'm the captain and I represent the team."

"No," Noah says, "stop using your captain card everywhere, for fuck's sake."

"It was my idea, this entire thing was my idea. I asked the universe for a girl, someone to share our lives with, our victories with. It was all me. It should be me!" I say, loudly like I didn't just shush them when they were being noisy as I open our hotel room door.

"Shhh," Brady says. "Fucking idiot."

And immediately I feel bad because she's sitting in the chair again and I forgot she had an online class, her phone propped up against a vase.

"And just for that, she's never wearing your jersey ever," Noah hisses.

"Fuck off," I whisper back.

We creep into the room. She doesn't acknowledge us, and I don't know, there's just something so hot when she's doing her nerdy student stuff. Geology is actually a pretty fascinating area, it's not just rocks and sand and shit. Or maybe I just find it interesting because our Wonder Girl loves it.

Right now she's contributing something, talking about intrusive, igneous rocks, and it sounds so complicated, but fuck, so hot. One day, I'm gonna fuck her as she lectures me about how they form.

When she's done, the professor gives her due praise. That's my girl. She glances up at us, and I smile at her, and she smiles back. If she knew the dirty thoughts I was having right now, I wonder if her smile would widen or if it would wipe off. Fuck, I can feel my cock pulsing. She's still eyeing me, and I swear, there's a connection

between us that I can't explain but I'm sure she can sense I'm having dirty thoughts about her. She's wearing this short skirt and she opens her legs a little to show me the black panties I want to pull off with my teeth.

I hear the other two draw in a sharp breath each.

She sees what she's done to us, what she's always doing to us, and she spreads her legs wider, giving us the full view as her professor prattles on.

I don't want to disturb her, but damn, I'm thinking with my cock right now. I move, then get on my knees in front of her and the table. I grab her ass seated on the chair and move her crotch towards my face.

This is what she gets for teasing me.

Her face appears under the table. "Sean?" she whispers. "What are you doing?"

"Dishing out consequences," I whisper back and bury my face between her legs.

She just manages to place a hand over her mouth, stifling the cry of surprise and pleasure.

"Ava?" the professor says.

"Yes, Dr. Smith," Ava says, breathlessly, sitting back up. "Sorry, I dropped my pen."

"As I was saying..." Dr. Smith continues as I inhale her. She smells amazing, like fruit and lavender. I free my cock, rubbing it as I lick through the fabric. Her body tenses and I'm dying to see what her face looks like. Hopefully, she's keeping it straight.

I feel her hand crawling in my hair instead of pushing me away. She presses my face closer to her pussy.

Fuck .

She must have an amazing poker face because the professor's still going. Although I can hear her breathing rate increase, it's not

too loud for people on her call to notice. She opens her legs wider, giving me better access, and I slip her panties to the side, giving the first full-contact lick.

She coughs, hiding her moan. I slip my tongue in between her folds and I could do this all day with how good she fucking tastes.

I feel a tap on my shoulder. I look around to see Brady's face.

"What?" I growl like a wolf guarding its kill.

"Do you want the lesson to end before I get a turn?" he whispers. "Move!"

I want to punch him but then I do like sharing with my bros, so I move to the side, giving him access to her wet cunt. I also get to see her reaction as Brady eats her.

"Just don't make her come, edge her," I say.

"Yeah, yeah," Brady says impatiently and he buries his face in.

When I stand up I see Ava's face. She's relatively sitting still, but she's biting her lip *so damn hard*. I'm kind of concerned she might draw blood.

Brady eats pussy so fucking loudly, he's making out with it and I kick him lightly.

"Do it quieter," I whisper. He kicks me back to say he's got the message.

I watch her. A crease has formed in between her eyebrows but it just looks like she's concentrating hard on what's being discussed, it's not enough to give her away.

Our girl is so good at hiding how her cunt is getting devoured by an icy forward. If this came out, shit, the PR would be fucking hell. And the fact that the captain allowed it to happen? Honestly, the thought just makes my cock harder.

I stroke it harder. Noah's watching the whole thing with his own tatted monster out, teasing it in that way he does by just touching the

tip, enough to get him to come if he's properly turned on, and it looks like he's close.

"Don't come until you've had a taste," I say.

"Not a chance," he says. "I won't forgive myself if I come without tasting online class pussy."

Brady pulls himself away from her with all the strength he can muster and I see a glimpse of her drenched inner thighs. before Noah dives in, making her throw her head back, hiding it by stretching.

"Do you have anything to say about what Annie just said, Ava?" the professor says.

She clears her throat, her voice high-pitched. "Yes." She sounds lustful but to an unsuspecting person, it just sounds like she's trying not to doze off. She gives her contribution, stammering her words.

"Excellent as always," the professor says as Noah goes in for the kill, sucking on her clit.

I stroke my cock faster as Brady comes into his palm quietly, looking up at the ceiling. Pleasure is beginning to show on our girl's face: her reddened lips are opening, her pretty eyes rolling. I do the responsible thing and step forward, placing a finger on the phone's front-facing camera before hanging up.

She looks grateful for this and throws her head back, releasing the loudest, most sexual moan I've ever heard as Noah takes a firm hold of her thighs, keeping her in place while sucking on her. She comes so fucking hard and I do too, groaning like a fucking wild animal.

"Fuck!" I say, my deep voice mixing in with Ava's high-pitched one as Noah continues to eat her out, spilling himself onto the floor.

"You g-guys, I - what the fuck?" She's breathless and red in the face, sweating a little. I guess holding in her moans was not unlike taking a workout.

“Don't start shit you can't handle,” I pant and she looks outraged at this. She stands on wobbly legs, stumbling a little into Noah who steadies her. She regains her balance and reaches me, pushing me onto the bed and climbing on top of me.

“I didn't start *anything*,” she rages while trying to wipe a smile off her face. “You're the one who did, this is all your fault, Captain!”

I laugh, bringing her to me, holding her close, and planting a kiss on her slightly sweaty forehead. “Do you want me to apologize?”

“I want you to apologize,” she says, her voice still breathless and a little shaky.

“How about...” I say, deliberating. “... I apologize by making you come again?” I say, mock earnestly.

She thinks about it, looking at Brady and Noah. Brady's already hard again, leaking from the end of his cock, while Noah's watching her like he's hungry for more, his chin glistening with her come.

“Make that three more times,” she says with the naughtiest of grins.

A couple of hours later, it's game time. Game 7 of the Stanley Cup Finals.

Fucking hell, man.

We had our first pre-game ritual of a regular breakfast earlier and now it's time for the pre-game meal that's right after the match. This is weird but we only drink coconut juice. I don't know how or why but it just makes sense.

We order it up and drink only half a cup each. Don't want to drink too much or else you'll need a bathroom break when you're about to shoot the puck at the goal.

After that we leave a limp and come-covered Ava in the hotel room and go to the arena across the road in suits, fans pouring

through the entrances. In the locker room, our equipment managers are doing equipment checks and Coach Johnson is beyond nervous, biting his fingernails and massaging his temple.

The lineup is the HCH line, our defensemen Patel and Harris, and McDonald, our goalie.

“Let's do it, y'all,” McDonald calls out, “let's visualize our victory.”

Visualizing victory is another of our pregame rituals we use to psych ourselves up. There's energy in the universe, it's buzzing. It's concentrated in this locker room, and it's gonna make us win and hoist the Cup, I'm sure of it.

I think of myself skating the rink with it. I think of Ava at my side. I think of my parents' laughing faces. I'm going to win it for my team, for my home city.

Then it's time for me to do a short pre-game interview, where I'm asked if I'm nervous.

“Nah,” I say. “I've never been more at peace.”

We warm up doing several formations as the crowd courses in. So much energy, so much anticipation. I wave at some fans, and do a couple of stretches.

She's already here, wearing a jersey.

We do drills. We do line rushes and execute all the plays we talked about in our strategy meetings. I'm sure all of that will pay off. Right before the puck drops, we go back to the locker room and receive one more motivational speech from Coach Johnson.

“It's alright if we don't win,” he says, “I just want you to go out there and do your best. And more importantly, have fun. Because that's the spirit of hockey.”

We shout “ICY FOR THE WIN” before skating out. We sing the national anthem and afterward, the moment of truth is here.

The face-off.

Just before the puck drops, I look at her. Her hands are over her mouth and it looks like she's holding in a breath. I wink at her and play starts.

Chapter 14

Ava

I'm with Cameron, and the families of the players wearing Brady's number 2 blue and red jersey. I made them play Rock, Paper, Scissors because they weren't gonna leave the hotel room until I made my decision about whose I was wearing. Noah was the first to get knocked out, then Sean, meaning Brady won.

"See?" he said loudly, happy like he just won the Stanley Cup. "I told you it was gonna be me!"

I'd wear the other two jerseys in the other two periods to make it fair, and when Brady heard this, he temporarily stopped celebrating and turned it over and over in his head to see if he liked it or not.

"That's... actually a great solution. Why didn't we think of that?"

"Because we're fucking idiots," Noah said.

I was surprised they weren't nervous. I'm the complete opposite. I feel *tense* and I'm pissed there's no space to pace in our row so I have to stay put in my seat.

"Relax," Cameron says, massaging my shoulders. "We've got this, we're gonna take it."

The Otters score just then.

"Okay, now I don't know." He stands up and mutters, looking at McDonald, "Come on baby, you can do this, I know you can."

Our goalie gets up on the other end, shaking his head as the Otters celebrate, the arena loud with cheers. Now Cameron looks tense too but not for long because three minutes later, Noah scores for the Icy and the relief that floods through me is orgasmic.

“Fuck yes, baby!” I scream as the period ends. I rummage in my pink backpack and take out Sean’s number 55 jersey, taking off Brady’s and putting it neatly away.

When play resumes, Sean immediately scores and I’m banging at the glass. “Yes! Go fucking icy!”

But our celebration is short-lived when the Otters make it 2-2.

“That’s okay, that’s okay!” I hear Lainey tell everyone, tying her long dark hair in a ponytail like shit is getting real. “We can come back from this!”

I try to call Kelly for emotional support, but the signal for some reason is really bad here so during the second intermission, I leave Cameron after giving him a comforting squeeze on the shoulder, heading for the exit.

Away from the arena and near the bathrooms, I’m looking like an idiot, my phone at arm’s length in front of me, holding it at this angle and that angle, that I don’t even look where I’m going and bump... into Angie, of all people.

After we recover from our head-on collision, I see she looks well. She’s glowing, I’ve never seen her look this beautiful. Or I just haven’t laid eyes on her in a long time after hanging out with her almost every day of my life.

“Hello? Hello?” Kelly says through my phone.

“Hey, Kelly,” I say. “You won’t believe who I just ran into.”

“The President? I heard he was attending the game —”

“Babe?” I hear Will’s voice say. Angie looks behind her.

“Wait, was that... *Will* ?” Kelly says in disbelief over the phone.

“Yeah, I just bumped into Angie and him at the arena.” I hear commentary from Kelly’s end, something about the Otters potentially clinching a victory but it’s cut off because Kelly has started cussing, which quickly turns into gloating.

“Hey, Will!” she calls. “Guess who Ava is with now, bitch? I mean, you've probably heard about it.”

I look at Will, who's glaring at me like he wants to shove me to the ground. I stand there defiantly.

“I'm guessing you guys came to support the Icy,” I say to him. “You can never make up your mind about them, can you?”

“No, I came to support the Otters, actually,” Will says, with a sneer.

“Okay, well, good luck,” I say, already bored and I'm about to pass when Angie says, “It's not gonna end well.”

“Oh, she speaks,” I say. “What do you mean it's not going to end well? The game?”

Her arm snakes through Will's and I fight the urge to roll my eyes.

Will is smirking. “She really doesn't know, does she?” he says.

I raise my eyebrows while Angie shakes her head, looking up adoringly at him.

I shake my head and leave. Kelly is still cussing and I tell her they're gone.

“You okay?” she says.

“I'm *definitely* okay,” I say. The whole thing is hilarious because why did she clutch his arm like that? Like I was going to steal him from her?

“No, not about *those* two. I mean about the match,” Kelly says.

“Oh, right. Yeah, I'm really nervous. Literally sweating. Hold on, I think it's back.”

“Yeah, it is. Talk to you later.”

I make kissy sounds before hanging up and rush back to Cameron. I take off Sean's jersey and put on Noah's number 31.

We can do this.

Hockey's a very fast sport. One second the players are on one end – you blink – and then they're on the other. There's a lot of shoving and a few minutes into the last period, Harris is throwing punches.

We can do this, we can do this.

And then Brady is attacking. They do some kind of complex formation that makes me hold my breath, hoping it works, and... and... Goal! "Fucking goal!" I screech. 3-2!

The Icy crowd around Brady and my racing heart skips a beat because what if they crush him? And they shouldn't celebrate so early, there's still two minutes left. I can't watch. I bury my face in my knees.

"Thirty seconds left," Cameron says hoarsely after a while, "you can watch now."

I sit up. Our guys just need to defend their goal.

Ten seconds.

Anxious excitement bubbles inside me as the Otters launch a ruthless attack.

Five seconds.

They weave past a stunned Harris and Patel and it's just the Otters forward and McDonald, our goalie.

The player shoots—

And McDonald kicks the puck away from the goal.

And the scream I scream is beastly. Monstrous. *Deranged* . Cameron and I are hugging each other like we want to merge into one being.

It happened.

They're the champions, the Stanley Cup winners!

The guys are going crazy on the ice, lifting McDonald into the air and my heart is going to fucking break into a million pieces.

Things have died down and my throat hurts from yelling. No regrets, though, as the presentation ceremony begins, the owner of the Icy making a speech. Then Coach Johnson, who's blubbing like the awesome big baby he is, is interviewed, the man who just coached the team to their first-ever Stanley Cup.

Sean is up next. He's speechless, he can barely get any words out as the interviewer asks her questions and then he's presented with the cup, which he hoists above his head before skating across the arena to massive cheers.

Then he gives it to Patel who skates to loud whoops. Then it's Brady. Then Harris. Then Martin. Then McDonald. Then Noah, and it goes on like that...

Afterwards, the players pause with a few fans for photos while the arena empties of Otters' spectators, leaving behind mostly shocked Icy fans. I watch them, giving them space. Cameron is with McDonald and they're making out right in the middle of the rink.

I want to go and I want to plant kisses all over my guys' faces, too. Not gonna lie, I want them to hoist me above their heads and skate with me across the rink because that looks like so much fun.

But then I find myself still behind the glass.

I'm being ridiculous. What is this weird fear that's holding me back, I don't understand it. Is it because it feels like we've reached the end of a road? That we finally got what we wanted and now we can... part ways?

I shake my head, take a deep breath, then step into the rink, and I'm expecting to slip, but I'm pretty steady in my thin-soled tennis shoes. I walk slowly towards Sean who's close by, a ton of fans and team personnel surrounding him, all wanting to get a piece of him. I stand at the edge of the small crowd, watching him with the biggest smile on my face because he looks so happy, so alive. He did it. He led his team into the final, and they fucking won.

He sees me, our eyes lock.

And then he cringes, his entire face twisting into an expression I've never seen before. My heart drops like a rock in my chest when he looks away.

I do a full U-turn, looking for Brady and Noah, but they are being inundated with fans, too. I'm too scared to approach them so I walk back to the stands, slumping in the nearest seat.

Staring into space, my hands shaking a little, I get an urge to call Kelly, so I pull my phone out, opening it to the last page I Googled about the Icy, and when it refreshes, my eyes land on a new tabloid headline that says: *Who is Ava Anderson, The NHL's Hottest 'Puck Bunny' And Internet Sensation ?*

While I was aware people were discussing me online, I didn't know I was some kind of "internet sensation". It's a tabloid headline, though and they're probably exaggerating. Still, "puck bunny" makes me open the link and read. The article alludes to me being some kind of good luck charm, as disclosed by an "unknown source close to the team".

It's probably a bullshit source they made up, but... what if it's true? What if that's all I am, a pawn? I know hockey players sometimes get with girls they think will give them luck because they'll do anything to win, even break girls' hearts.

I think of the girls I met in the bathroom at Denny's. Were they right? With the look Sean gave me, it looks like it. And then, with a pang, I think this is what Will and Angie were probably looking smug about. Angie loves celebrity gossip, so she would've read this article and told Will about it.

In spite of myself, I find myself hugging Noah's number 31 I'm wearing. I want to live in the feeling I felt an hour ago when we won.

When *they* won. Apparently, there is no we.

I'm about to leave, the tears shining in my eyes when I hear Sean speak into the mic, and my hands fly to my mouth.

Chapter 15

Noah

The fans, the fucking fans. I want to hug each and every single one of them.

Fuck, I haven't been this happy since I don't even know when. Man, we just won the fucking Stanley Cup Finals! I keep punching my thigh hard to make sure I'm not in some kind of dream, because what is life?

The fans want their shit signed and I'm gonna sign every single fucking thing they give me because *we just won the Stanley Cup Finals*.

"Y'all have any idea how much you mean to me?" I yell to the crowd and they cheer! They're just as happy as I am!

"ICY, ICY, ICY!" we shout.

I'm grateful for all the fortune that found me this season and I'm super grateful for one new person in my life.

I haven't seen her in at least three minutes, I've been glancing at the stands where she's watching the celebrations unfold, wanting to make my way there, but the fans keep coming and I can't deny these lovable people, can I? Their support is the reason we got here in the first place.

I haven't played that well all season. The Otters were fucking vicious this game but it wasn't enough, they couldn't break through the fucking ice.

"One more thing!" I hear a booming voice say. Sean is back on the raised platform and has the mic. "I've thanked my parents countless on my journey to the Stanley Cup, thanks again Mom and Dad, but I also just wanted to thank someone really special, who

just came into our lives. In addition to dedicating this to my family, Ava, I want to dedicate this Stanley Cup win to you. Thank you baby for... finding us when we needed someone like you the most."

I sign the last five autographs quickly and skate towards the raised platform because I need to say something too.

Brady gets there first. "Yeah, Ava!" he yells, looking in the direction of the stands, where she's standing with her hands over her mouth. "You mean the world to us, Wonder Girl!"

I walk up to my two teammates, taking the mic that Brady hands over to me. "Ava, we can't wait to spend our lives together with you!" I say.

I see her. She's running towards us, hair flowing behind her, wearing my jersey, *my* number and the sight is the most glorious thing I've ever seen as she steps onto the raised platform. She flies into my open arms, and begins to kiss me so ferociously, I stumble back a little and I lift her off her feet, inhaling her lavender perfume that reminds me of home while people around us cheer.

When we come up for air, breathing hard like we were underwater, tears are streaming down her face. "Baby!" I say, a little worried. "You okay?"

"I'm happy, so happy, Noah," she says, kissing me some more, drawing the air right out of me again, before she jumps into Sean's arms, pressing her lips to his.

"You okay?" Sean says when they break apart, studying her face, his hand lifting her chin to inspect her. "I saw you standing there just now, all alone and it... broke my heart. So I thought I would do something to cheer you up and make you feel more welcome with my speech. Did it work?"

She nods vigorously, looking so happy which makes me even happier than I can possibly be right now. "It worked and I was stupid to even feel alone and like I was intruding, when I have you three. Congratulations! I'm so, so proud of you three!"

Before we can thank her, she crashes her mouth back on Sean's again and they make out violently before it's Brady's turn, who's seemingly been waiting for his turn his entire life, and he kisses her back so enthusiastically that he's gonna eat our girl's face off.

Chapter 16

Brady

When I finish making out with our girl, I lift her from the floor, tucking her possessively close to my chest and she gives a little yelp of delighted surprise. I skate to the locker room entrance where I know celebrations are underway, the other two trailing us. As I'm carrying her, I see someone familiar in the stands.

It's her ex, I recognize him from the picture she showed us yesterday. He's looking at us like he wants to come over and start something in the rink. I dare him to – Noah, Sean, and I have each gotten into countless brawls on and off the ice. He comes to his senses though, staying put. In one hand is an Otters' jersey (womp, womp), and clinging to his other is a girl who must be the traitorous best friend, who's trying to get his attention but gets shrugged off, causing her to storm off.

Ava watches them, a satisfied smile on her beautiful face and I like to see our girl satisfied.

"There they are!" McDonald, our Conn Smythe Trophy winner, roars when we enter the locker room and I don't think the cheers that filled the arena when he blocked the puck from entering the goal were louder. This shit is about to give me a three-day headache.

"Fuck, yeah!" I yell, contributing to the noise nonetheless because we just won the fucking Stanley Cup and the girl of my dreams is in my arms, screaming her joy.

Life can't be real.

I put our girl down, touching my lips to hers again, those soft, soft lips I know I'm going to spend forever kissing and her feet haven't even touched the floor when Cameron, whose soaked to the bone, douses us in champagne.

Ava, wet and laughing, hugs Cameron and they freak out in each other's faces. She dances with the kids who are running all over the place and damn, do I want to be a dad one day.

"I can't believe it," Sean says, watching Ava with the burning affection I also feel. He's talking softly but I can hear his voice over the chants as clearly as if he's speaking right into my ear. Just three nights ago we were feeling empty and now our hearts are full. "We got everything we wanted. How crazy is that?"

"Right?" Noah says, grinning at Ava who sees us looking at her and smiles, an angel on earth, before she picks up Harris's kid and spins.

It's a special moment and we're having it with someone who's quickly and unexpectedly become the center of our world in just three days and who I know will be our center forever. Three days of an immediate, inexplicable connection, amusement, held breaths, and lovemaking that have determined our lives going forward.

Chapter 17

Ava

When my eyes open, I am between soft sheets with a hangover, morning light pouring in through drawn curtains.

“There she is,” Noah says in a muffled voice, sitting in the chair shirtless, his dragon tattoo snaking across his defined, broad chest. “Good morning, beautiful.”

My eyes open wider and I see him biting something. Cake.

“Good morning, handsome.” I smile, remembering last night. The Icy earning their first Cup, the moment I jumped to conclusions and mistakenly thought I got betrayed, how my mind and heart were racing, only to be claimed on live TV by all three of my men, and the relief, the joy that they still wanted me as much as I wanted them coursing through me...

I also remember how wasted everyone got and how I had to be carried back to our room by Noah after drunkenly baking a Neopolitan cake with all three of my men’s favorite flavors. Lainey and I went shopping for utensils and ingredients at freaking midnight and after I mixed the ingredients and poured the separate mixtures into a circular tray, we begged the kitchen staff to bake it for us, which they reluctantly did, and when we took out the cake from the tray, I put the black icing on and voila, it was a giant puck cake!

I look around the room. Brady and Sean are standing around the bed, Sean with a crumb of cake at the corner of his lips, and Brady popping the last of his piece into his mouth, making a rumbling sound of pleasure that awakens my core.

“Wait, did you each have a part of your favorite flavors? Even if I was drunk as fuck, I made sure to include all three. Velvet, vanilla, and chocolate.”

All three of them nod, grinning.

"Did you like it?" I ask, uncertain if drunkenly made cake tastes good.

"Loved it," Sean says.

Noah kisses his fingers.

"Delicious," Brady says.

I sigh contentedly. "I'm glad you did," I say, smiling. "My gift to you for winning the Stanley Cup!"

We relive last night some more, the plays, McDonald's save, Patel lying drunk and face down in the middle of a road somewhere, until our bodies begin to sing for each other. Brady, on whose lap I'm sitting in, kisses me, filling me with desire and I suck on his bottom lip as we come up for air.

"Don't tempt me, Wonder," he growls.

I lean forward and kiss him again, deep and hungry, and he returns it, placing his large hand behind my neck, pressing me more into him. I shove him backward onto the bed and jam my tongue in his mouth. My hand moves down to his cock in his sweatpants and he grunts, placing his hands on my ass. I feel him peel my shorts off, exposing my ass and pussy. He spansks me and I moan into his mouth.

I moan even louder when I feel a hot tongue in my ass.

When I break the kiss to look behind me, I see Noah, his hands on my ass, spreading my cheeks apart. Sean is watching the whole thing, rubbing his cock through his basketball shorts.

"Please eat my pussy," I whimper to Sean.

He likes to be begged and he growls, "Whatever you want, baby" before placing his head below Noah's and licking my clit. I moan as Brady grabs the back of my neck again and brings me back down to our kiss. It's messy, hot, and needy and I'm groaning into his mouth.

Then he breaks the kiss. "Have you ever tried DP, baby?"

I shake my head. "I want to, though. I won't lie, I've thought about it a few times these past few days."

His eyes darken as he runs a thumb along my mouth, pushing it past my lips and making him groan when I suck.

"Let's all take off our clothes," Sean says.

Noah sits back in the chair where they ate me out yesterday. I mount him, kissing him, running my tongue over his neck as he growls with pleasure before I ease down onto his tatted cock, throwing my head back at the overwhelming sensation in my core. We don't have lube so Brady spits on his cock and strokes it while Noah spits on his fingers and brings them to my ass as I lightly bounce on his thick cock.

"Relax, baby," he whispers. He puts a finger in while still stroking his cock. Moaning, I loosen up. He puts another finger, and then after a while of fucking my ass gently, I'm open and ready. Brady brings his cock to my entrance and then slowly eases in. I thought it would be painful, but it just feels amazing and really full.

My ass and pussy are full of two big cocks.

"You okay?" Noah says, looking up at me. I look into his green eyes and nod, unable to speak because fuck, this feels so *fucking* good.

Brady begins to move back and forth very slowly, praising how well I'm taking it, and then picks up the pace as I begin to fuck Noah's cock.

"Fuck, just like that, baby," Noah says around a nipple as I moan loudly, "you're doing so good for us."

Sean, who's been stroking his cock this whole time, comes and stands behind the chair. Without being asked to, I open my mouth and he puts it in.

With all three of my holes filled, I've never felt so at home. Sean begins to fuck my mouth as Brady pounds into me harder. My moans are muffled, and my pussy is making wet, slippery sounds. The guys

are absolutely losing it, their groans and growls filling up the space as they fuck me, their wonder girl.

"You're so pretty when you're looking up at me like that," Sean says, placing his thumb on the corner of my lips. Brady spans my ass as Noah sucks and pulls my breasts with his teeth. The sensations, they're intense, they're everywhere. I come three times in quick succession, which I didn't know was possible, and by the time all three men release at the same time, which looks like something they've trained themselves to do, my body is singing.

They place me gently on the bed and cuddle around me. Noah brings the remaining piece of cake, and when I eat it, I'm surprised by how good it tastes.

We're in bed laughing, reliving last night some more because we're still in disbelief about the win, and they recall how hot I looked in each of their oversized jerseys, how they swear they could hear my scream each time the Icy scored.

It's peaceful. The puck from last night is on the nightstand, beside an empty plate littered with cake crumbs and a paper with notes on volcanic rock. The room is bright. It smells of sex and expensive cologne. And love.

We fly back home to Toronto. The players' partners are all nursing hangovers as we discuss the game, while the guys are mostly resting after partying too hard last night and working their asses off all season. At the airport is a deluge of supporters and media. The Toronto Icy smile, laugh, and wave at the chanting fans before proceeding to the arena to do some press while the families of the players are going home or elsewhere. I'm going to my parents' house and Kelly will be there.

I kiss each of my men, warm kisses that tell me they already miss me before we've even separated and when Mom comes to pick me up and I get into her car where she's dying to know everything that happened, I'm already craving to see them again.

“Mama,” I sigh with happiness after I tell her most of the unlikely fairytale, “do you think it's crazy I know who my soulmates are after three days?”

She smiles at the road ahead of her. “No love is the same, Avy,” she says. “Ever. For some, it takes six years to fall in love, as your dad and I did. For others, it takes an hour.” Her smile grows wistful. “Sometimes, it takes a little more time, and sometimes you just know you've found that person you're going to spend forever with the second you lock eyes with them.”

Epilogue

Three years later

Ava

Cherry, Sugar, and Moose, our three corgis, are trying to go outside and enjoy the summer midday. They've been circling my chair by the kitchen table for the past five minutes, and I keep getting distracted by work, forgetting to just open the door so they can run out into the very green and very mature garden with tall cypress trees and wide stretches of lawn.

Cherry, the leader and loudest of the three, gives a frustrated yelp that makes me think she's hurt, effectively taking me out of my work zone.

"Oh, I'm so sorry, babies!" I say, putting down the tray of ocean sediment core I'm studying with a magnifying glass, and jogging across the warm-colored and homely living area of our mansion to open the sliding doors. "Go out, you little rascals," I say as they race out.

Before I shut the door, I take in a deep breath of the clean and fresh air, savoring the tranquility of our property, which is away from the city, and the only thing you can hear are birds and squirrels.

When I get back inside, my phone rings: Cameron is inviting me, Lainey, and Kelly into a video call.

"I'm bored," he says, a deadpan expression on his face as he lies in bed, a gigantic picture of him and McDonald on their wedding day above him.

Lainey is trying to placate her and Patel's screaming two-year-old while Kelly looks like she has something to spill.

“You okay, babes?” I say to my BFF. She heaves a great sigh and says, “I think I'm falling in love with a coworker.”

Lainey, Cameron and I have our eyes progressively widen with alarm as Kelly goes on a rant about what she wants to do to this (un)fortunate man she works with, who's an assistant counselor like she is at a private practice.

“We'll need to come up with a full-blown strategy,” I say to Kelly, realizing hockey has made me think everything needs strategic planning. “That man doesn't know what he's missing out on.”

After half an hour of laughs, my phone beeps with a text from my boss, a senior geologist at Mapler Labs where I was hired seven months ago as a junior geologist, and for my report, she wants me to study the shale samples too as soon as possible.

To thoroughly look at the shale samples, I'll need to take off my ring, a non-traditional wedding band my three husbands and I all have.

As always, I get so distracted by work I don't even feel the hours pass and I only get brought back to planet Earth when I hear the Ferrari ease into the driveway.

The puppies start screaming whenever our Daddies are home. I do too, although it's more internal screaming.

Sean, Brady, and Noah enter the kitchen, each of them carrying a puppy and their gym bags. I'll never get tired of seeing them carrying our dogs. It's a lot of things: the way they dote on the puppies and how tiny the corgis look in their bulging arms. I immediately leave what I'm doing and fly into Sean's arms, kissing him.

“I missed you,” he says, rubbing his face in my neck and inhaling.

“I missed you too,” I say, inhaling the citrus scent of his thick dark hair.

He transfers me gently into Brady's arms who bites me on the neck, making me yelp and therefore causing Cherry to yelp.

"How was practice?" I ask him.

"You know the deadly combination that is Sean Campbell and Coach Johnson," he says, kissing me.

He deposits me into Noah's arms. Noah kisses my forehead. "How was your day?" he says.

"Busy, but ten minutes don't go by without me thinking of you three. As always," I say, bringing my lips to his. Moose starts licking both our faces and we laugh.

"I'll make us dinner," Sean says. "I'm fucking famished."

An hour later we're eating lamb and roast potatoes, the puppies chasing each other across the house. For dessert, we have the brownies I baked yesterday with Mom and when we're done, I place the dishes in the sink. I smell Noah's distinct bergamot cologne.

"Leave the dishes, I'll do them tomorrow morning," he says. "Just come and talk dirty to me right now." His arms wrap around my waist and I feel his cock growing on my back.

I smile, turn around, and jump into his arms. He carries me upstairs to our massive bedroom with tan and brown colors, where the other two are lying on our Alaska king, watching highlights on their phones. In a corner, four large teddy bears sit watching us.

"What do you want me to talk about today?" I say, want already filling my core.

"Igneous rocks?" Sean says, stretching. "I remember — we talked about those in Chicago."

I think of that all-consuming time three years ago. A lot has happened since, including Brady's season-long injury the following year, my graduation, several brawls, and another Stanley Cup for the Icy last year against the Denver Rage.

“Okay, then,” I say in a husky voice, and all three of their gazes darken on me as we begin our very weird but very hot college professor-student play. I can already see the tent Noah’s made in his sweats and I smile, getting on my knees in front of him, caressing the bulge and making unwavering eye contact. “Igneous rocks are really, *really hard* rocks formed when *hot* magma *hardens* ...”

“Ah, fuck, this will never get old,” Brady mutters, rubbing his cock through his jeans.

Practice and training are exhausting, so they almost always fall asleep first. Most nights, I also quickly fall under, but tonight I’m just feeling extra grateful to be loved every day by these three men I will forever call my own.

I plant a kiss on Brady’s chest and that wakes him up.

“What’s up?” he says and he says it so loudly that Sean and Noah jerk awake.

“What is it?” Seans says groggily.

“The house on fire?” Noah mumbles.

“Nothing,” I laugh. “I’m just... feeling super loved right now, that’s all. Sorry to wake you up.”

Sean grunts sleepily. “Here’s some more of it,” he says. “I love you, Ava Anderson.”

“I love you, baby,” Brady says.

“I love you, Wonder Girl,” Noah sighs.

I’m grinning like an idiot because I’m so damn lucky. “I love you, Sean. I love you, Brady. I love you, Noah.”

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